The Wikipeterson Cookbook

65 recipes to keep.

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Contents

15-Minute Creamy Tomato Soup

Acai Bowl

Air Fryer Asparagus

Air Fryer Bacon

Air Fryer Mashed Potato Cakes

Air-Fryer Red Potatoes

Avocado Corn Chicken Salad

Baked Beans

Baked Gruyère in Pastry

Bang Bang Ji Si Chicken Salad

Barbecue Pulled Pork Sandwiches

Beef Jerky

Bruschetta

Cauliflower Chicken Fried Rice

Cheesy Gruyere & Swiss Roasted Asparagus

Chicken Caesar Smash Tacos

Chicken Cordon Bleu

Chicken Salad

Christmas Breakfast Casserole

Cobb Salad

Corn Bread

Corn Chowder (or Corn and Crab)

Corn on the Cob Boiled

Crab Cakes

Creamy Garlic Butter Tuscan Salmon

Espresso Martini

Excellent Meatballs

Fettuccine Alfredo

Fried Rice

Garlic Parmesan Wings

Gorgonzola Cream Sauce for Filet

Grilled Chicken Breasts

Ham and Cheese Sliders

High-Protein Ravioli Casserole

Honey Lemon Salmon

Hungarian Mushroom Soup

Instant Pot Broccoli Cheddar Soup

Instant Pot French Onion Soup

Instant Pot Hummus

Lemon Garlic Salmon

Lemon Pepper Chicken

London Broil

Mashed Potatoes

Mexican Rice Instant Pot

Mongolian Beef

P.F. Chang's Chicken Lettuce Wraps

Parmesan Roasted Potatoes

Pasta Salad

Pepperoni Garlic Knots

Pepperoni Pizza Sliders

Pressure Cooker Black Beans With Chorizo

Protein Pancakes

Protein Rice Crispy Treats

Shiitake Mushrooms

Sicilian Pizza

Sous Vide Asparagus

Sous Vide Carrots

Sous Vide Chicken Breast

Sous Vide Ribs

Sous Vide Steak

Sous Vide Tuna

Teriyaki Salmon

The Best Lemon Loaf

Tini's Mac and Cheese

Tzatziki Sauce

15-Minute Creamy Tomato Soup

Soups | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Equipment: saucepan and blender. Cook onion: about 4 minutes; simmer soup: about 5 minutes. Olive oil is divided: 2 Tbsp for cooking, then 3 Tbsp in each of two blender batches.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Aromatics and seasonings

- [ ] 1/2 cup extra-virgin olive oil, divided: 2 Tbsp for cooking; 3 Tbsp for each of two blender batches
- [ ] 2 cloves garlic, finely grated [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 small onion, finely sliced (about 1 cup) [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp dried oregano [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp red pepper flakes [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 slices white bread, crusts removed and torn into pieces
- [ ] 2 (28-oz) cans whole peeled tomatoes in juice
- [ ] Kosher salt and freshly ground black pepper, to taste
- [ ] Minced chives, basil, or parsley, for garnish
- [ ] Toast or grilled cheese, for serving
- [ ] 2 cups water
- [ ] Additional olive oil for serving, optional

1. Cook aromatics

1. Heat 2 Tbsp extra-virgin olive oil in a saucepan over medium-high heat.

2. Add 2 finely grated garlic cloves, 1 finely sliced small onion (about 1 cup), 1 tsp dried oregano, and 1/2 tsp red pepper flakes. Cook about 4 minutes, until onion softens without browning.

2. Simmer

1. Add 2 slices white bread, crusts removed and torn into pieces, and two 28 oz cans whole peeled tomatoes with their juice. Roughly crush the tomatoes.

2. Add 2 cups water. Bring to a boil, then simmer about 5 minutes.

3. Blend and finish

1. Blend the soup in two batches. Vent the blender lid and cover with a kitchen towel, as noted in the saved recipe.

2. While blending each batch on high, slowly drizzle in 3 Tbsp olive oil. This uses the remaining 6 Tbsp from the original 1/2 cup total and makes the soup creamy.

3. Season with kosher salt and freshly ground black pepper to taste.

4. Serve with minced chives, basil, or parsley, an optional extra drizzle of olive oil, and toast or grilled cheese.

Notes

Use care when blending hot soup; vent the blender lid and cover with a kitchen towel.

Acai Bowl

Breakfast | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Equipment: blender and serving bowl. Prepare toppings first and serve immediately after blending. Your optional honey addition is included in the steps and preserved in the notes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Blender ingredients; include optional additions if using

- [ ] 1/2 cup milk (plant-based if desired) [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 cup vanilla yogurt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 cup frozen mixed berries [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 medium frozen banana [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 1/2-2 Tbsp acai powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 scoop collagen powder (optional; omit for vegan) [Bowl A]
- [ ] Toppings: 1/2 sliced banana, 2 sliced strawberries, handful of blueberries, shredded coconut, chia seeds
- [ ] 1 1/2 Tbsp honey, optional personal addition [Bowl A]

1. Prepare toppings

1. Slice 1/2 banana and 2 strawberries for topping. Have a handful of blueberries, shredded coconut, and chia seeds ready.

2. Blend

1. Blend 1/2 cup milk (plant-based if desired), 1/4 cup vanilla yogurt, 1 cup frozen mixed berries, 1 medium frozen banana, and 1 1/2-2 Tbsp acai powder.

2. If desired, include 1 scoop collagen powder (omit for vegan) and your personal addition of 1 1/2 Tbsp honey.

3. Blend until smooth and creamy, stopping to stir as needed.

3. Finish

1. Pour into a bowl. Immediately top with the prepared 1/2 sliced banana, 2 sliced strawberries, handful of blueberries, shredded coconut, and chia seeds.

Notes

Personal note from Recipe Index: add 1.5 Tbsp honey.

Air Fryer Asparagus

Sides | Air fryer

Before you start

Equipment: air fryer. Temperature: 400°F. Cook: about 7 minutes, adjusting for spear thickness and desired tenderness.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Oil and seasonings

- [ ] 2 lb asparagus, rinsed and woody ends trimmed
- [ ] 1 Tbsp garlic-parsley salt, or to taste [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp oil [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/3 cup grated Parmesan [Bowl A]

1. Prepare and season

1. Rinse 2 lb asparagus and trim or snap off woody ends.

2. Arrange in a single layer in the air-fryer basket. Toss or season with 1 Tbsp oil, 1 Tbsp garlic-parsley salt (or to taste), and 1/3 cup grated Parmesan.

2. Air-fry

1. Air-fry at 400°F about 7 minutes, adjusting for thickness and desired tenderness.

2. Add a little extra Parmesan to serve if desired.

Air Fryer Bacon

Basics | Air fryer

Before you start

Equipment: air fryer and paper-towel-lined plate. Temperature: 350°F. Regular-cut bacon: about 7-9 minutes; thick-cut: about 10-12 minutes.

Ingredients

Keep these ingredients separate; follow the order in the directions.

- [ ] 5 slices bacon (about 6 oz regular-cut; thick-cut may require 8-12 oz depending on slice size)

1. Arrange

1. Arrange 5 bacon slices (about 6 oz regular-cut, or 8-12 oz thick-cut depending on slice size) in a single layer in the air-fryer basket. Cut strips in half if needed to fit.

2. Cook and drain

1. Cook at 350°F: about 7-9 minutes for regular-cut or 10-12 minutes for thick-cut, until browned and as crisp as desired.

2. Transfer to a paper-towel-lined plate. If cooking multiple batches, empty rendered fat from the drip pan between batches.

Air Fryer Mashed Potato Cakes

Basics | Air fryer

Before you start

Makes: 8 patties, about 1/2-3/4 inch thick. Equipment: air fryer and shallow dish. Preheat: 375°F for about 3 minutes. Cook: 8-10 minutes total, flipping halfway. Use cold mashed potatoes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Potato-mixture flavorings and flour

Bowl B - Parmesan-panko coating

- [ ] 2 cups cold mashed potatoes
- [ ] 1 large egg
- [ ] 3 garlic cloves, minced (or 1 tsp garlic powder) [Bowl A]
- [ ] 3 Tbsp all-purpose flour [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 cup grated Parmesan in the potato mixture [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 cup grated Parmesan for coating [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 tsp Italian seasoning [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 cup panko breadcrumbs [Bowl B]
- [ ] Salt and pepper to taste [Bowl A]
- [ ] Fresh parsley and sour cream, for serving
- [ ] Cooking spray or a light spritz of oil

1. Mix and shape

1. Combine 2 cups cold mashed potatoes, 1 large egg, 3 minced garlic cloves (or 1 tsp garlic powder), 3 Tbsp all-purpose flour, 1/2 cup grated Parmesan, 1 tsp Italian seasoning, and salt and pepper to taste.

2. If too soft, mix in 1-2 Tbsp additional flour.

3. In a shallow dish, mix another 1/2 cup grated Parmesan with 1/2 cup panko breadcrumbs.

4. Divide the potato mixture into 8 portions. Shape patties about 1/2-3/4 inch thick and coat each in the Parmesan-panko mixture.

2. Air-fry

1. Preheat the air fryer to 375°F for about 3 minutes. Lightly oil the basket and patties with cooking spray or a light spritz of oil.

2. Air-fry 8-10 minutes total, flipping halfway and lightly oiling the second side, until crisp and golden.

3. Serve

1. Cool briefly. Serve with fresh parsley and sour cream. Optional toppings: bacon crumbles and scallions.

Notes

Cold mashed potatoes hold their shape best. If the mixture is too soft, add 1-2 Tbsp additional flour.

Air-Fryer Red Potatoes

Sides | Air fryer

Before you start

Equipment: air fryer. Temperature: 400°F. Cook: 10-12 minutes, stirring once.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Oil and seasonings

- [ ] 2 lb small unpeeled red potatoes, cut into wedges
- [ ] 2 Tbsp olive oil [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp minced fresh rosemary or 1 tsp dried rosemary, crushed [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves, minced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp black pepper [Bowl A]

1. Prepare and season

1. Preheat the air fryer to 400°F.

2. Toss 2 lb small unpeeled red potatoes, cut into wedges, with 2 Tbsp olive oil, 1 Tbsp minced fresh rosemary (or 1 tsp crushed dried rosemary), 2 minced garlic cloves, 1/2 tsp salt, and 1/4 tsp black pepper.

2. Air-fry

1. Arrange the seasoned wedges on the air-fryer tray or in the basket. Cook 10-12 minutes, stirring once.

2. Ready when: the potatoes are golden and tender.

Avocado Corn Chicken Salad

Chicken | Oven

Before you start

Equipment: oven-safe skillet and mixing bowl. Oven: 400°F. Chicken: sear about 4 minutes per side, roast about 7 minutes until cooked through, then rest 5 minutes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Chicken seasonings

Bowl B - Dressing

Chicken salad:

- [ ] 4 chicken breasts
- [ ] 1 tsp salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp black pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp paprika [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp smoked paprika [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp cumin [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp chili powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp garlic powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp onion powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 3 avocados, large dice
- [ ] Kernels from 4 ears corn (about 1 cup)
- [ ] 1/4 cup finely chopped shallots
- [ ] 1/4 cup finely chopped fresh dill
- [ ] Avocado oil

Dressing:

- [ ] 1/3 cup olive oil [Bowl B]
- [ ] 3 Tbsp champagne vinegar [Bowl B]
- [ ] 3 Tbsp lemon juice [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 heaping Tbsp honey [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 heaping Tbsp Dijon mustard [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp salt [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp pepper [Bowl B]

Original recipe | Google Doc

- [ ] 2-3 slices bacon, cooked and crumbled, optional

1. Season and cook chicken

1. Heat the oven to 400°F. Coat 4 chicken breasts with avocado oil.

2. Mix 1 tsp salt, 1/2 tsp black pepper, 1 tsp paprika, 1 tsp smoked paprika, 1 tsp cumin, 1 tsp chili powder, 1/4 tsp garlic powder, and 1/4 tsp onion powder. Season the chicken with this mixture.

3. Sear in an oven-safe skillet over medium-high heat about 4 minutes per side. Roast about 7 minutes, or until cooked through. Rest 5 minutes, then dice.

2. Mix dressing while chicken cooks

1. Whisk 1/3 cup olive oil, 3 Tbsp champagne vinegar, 3 Tbsp lemon juice, 1 heaping Tbsp honey, 1 heaping Tbsp Dijon mustard, 1/2 tsp salt, and 1/4 tsp pepper.

3. Assemble

1. Gently combine the cooked diced chicken, 3 large-diced avocados, kernels from 4 ears corn, 1/4 cup finely chopped shallots, and 1/4 cup finely chopped fresh dill.

2. Toss gently with the dressing and season to taste. If desired, add 2-3 cooked, crumbled bacon slices.

Notes

Quantity note: the saved ingredient list describes kernels from 4 ears corn as about 1 cup. Those measures may not agree; this version retains the 4-ear count rather than silently changing the quantity.

Baked Beans

Sides | Oven

Before you start

Equipment: oven-safe skillet. Oven: 400°F. Bake: 30-35 minutes, after stovetop cooking.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Aromatics

Bowl B - Spice mixture

Bowl C - Sauce mixture

- [ ] 2 slices bacon, diced
- [ ] 1 small sweet onion, diced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 bell pepper, diced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves, minced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp smoked paprika [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4-1/2 tsp chipotle chili powder [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp salt [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp black pepper [Bowl B]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp apple cider vinegar [Bowl C]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp barbecue sauce [Bowl C]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp ketchup [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp Dijon mustard [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp brown sugar [Bowl C]
- [ ] 2 (22 oz) cans baked beans
- [ ] 2 additional bacon slices for topping, optional

1. Cook bacon and vegetables

1. Heat the oven to 400°F.
2. Cook 2 diced bacon slices in an oven-safe skillet until the fat renders and the bacon begins to crisp.
3. Add 1 diced small sweet onion, 1 diced bell pepper, and 2 minced garlic cloves. Cook about 5 minutes.
4. Stir in 1 Tbsp smoked paprika, 1/4-1/2 tsp chipotle chili powder, 1/4 tsp salt, and 1/4 tsp black pepper. Cook 1-2 minutes more.

2. Add beans and bake

1. Stir in 2 Tbsp apple cider vinegar, 2 Tbsp barbecue sauce, 2 Tbsp ketchup, 1 Tbsp Dijon mustard, 1 Tbsp brown sugar, and two 22 oz cans baked beans. Bring to a gentle boil, then turn off the heat.

2. If desired, lay 2 additional bacon slices over the top. Bake 30-35 minutes, until bubbly and slightly syrupy.

Baked Gruyère in Pastry

Appetizers | Oven

Before you start

Equipment: parchment-lined 10-12-inch baking dish or pie plate. Oven: 425°F. Bake: 25-30 minutes. Before starting: thaw the puff pastry.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Rosemary and garlic

- [ ] 1 sheet frozen puff pastry, thawed
- [ ] 1 lb Gruyère, Fontina, or a mixture, cut into cubes
- [ ] 1 Tbsp chopped fresh rosemary [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1-2 garlic cloves, grated [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 tsp honey, plus more for serving
- [ ] 1 egg, beaten
- [ ] Coarse sugar, for sprinkling
- [ ] Black pepper, bread, or crackers, for serving

1. Fill the pastry

1. Heat the oven to 425°F. Place 1 thawed sheet puff pastry in the parchment-lined dish.

2. Pile 1 lb cubed Gruyère, Fontina, or a mixture in the center. Sprinkle with 1 Tbsp chopped fresh rosemary and 1-2 grated garlic cloves. Drizzle with 2 tsp honey.

3. Fold the pastry edges up and over the cheese to enclose it. Brush with 1 beaten egg and sprinkle lightly with coarse sugar.

2. Bake and serve

1. Bake 25-30 minutes, until the pastry is deeply golden and the cheese is bubbling.

2. Serve hot with extra honey, black pepper, and bread or crackers, as desired.

Bang Bang Ji Si Chicken Salad

Chicken | Sous vide

Before you start

Equipment: sous-vide bath, food-safe bag, ice bath, and grinder or mortar. Cook: 150°F for 1-4 hours; chill about 15 minutes. Garlic and scallions are divided.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Ingredients to grind; add reserved garlic

Bowl B - Dressing liquids and sesame paste

- [ ] 1 3/4 lb bone-in, skin-on split chicken breasts
- [ ] Salt and black pepper
- [ ] 6 garlic cloves, divided: 3 for the cooking bag; 3 for the dressing
- [ ] 6 scallions, divided: 2 roughly chopped for the bag; 4 thinly sliced for serving
- [ ] 1-inch piece fresh ginger, sliced
- [ ] 2 tsp toasted Sichuan peppercorns [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp sugar [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 tsp sesame seeds, plus more for garnish [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp sesame paste [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp soy sauce [Bowl B]
- [ ] 4 tsp Chinkiang or black vinegar [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4 cup chile oil with sediment [Bowl B]

1. Cook and chill chicken

1. Season 1 3/4 lb bone-in, skin-on split chicken breasts with salt and black pepper.

2. Bag with 3 garlic cloves (half of the 6), 2 roughly chopped scallions (from the 6), and one sliced 1-inch piece ginger.

3. Sous vide at 150°F for 1-4 hours. Chill in an ice bath about 15 minutes.

2. Make dressing

1. Grind 2 tsp toasted Sichuan peppercorns, 1 Tbsp sugar, the remaining 3 garlic cloves, and 2 tsp sesame seeds into a rough paste.

2. Work in 1 Tbsp sesame paste, 1 Tbsp soy sauce, 4 tsp Chinkiang or black vinegar, and 1/4 cup chile oil with sediment.

3. Stir about 2 Tbsp chicken bag juices into the dressing.

3. Shred and toss

1. Remove chicken skin and bones and shred the meat. Thinly slice the remaining 4 scallions.
2. Toss the chicken with the dressing and sliced scallions. Adjust seasoning.
3. If desired, garnish with extra scallions, sesame seeds, and chile oil.

Barbecue Pulled Pork Sandwiches

Beef & pork | Instant Pot

Before you start

Makes: 12 sandwiches. Equipment: Instant Pot and two forks. High pressure: 1 hour, then quick-release, plus time to reach pressure and reduce the sauce. Brown sugar and water are divided.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Rub spices; add reserved sugar and measured salt/pepper

Bowl B - Cooking-liquid base; add reserved sugar and water

- [ ] 3 Tbsp light brown sugar, divided: 1 Tbsp for rub; 2 Tbsp for cooking liquid
- [ ] 2 tsp hot paprika [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp mustard powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp ground cumin [Bowl A]
- [ ] Kosher salt and black pepper
- [ ] 4 lb boneless pork shoulder, trimmed and cut into 6 pieces
- [ ] 2 tsp vegetable oil
- [ ] 1/2 cup apple cider vinegar, plus more to taste [Bowl B]
- [ ] 3 Tbsp tomato paste [Bowl B]
- [ ] 12 hamburger potato buns
- [ ] 1 cup barbecue sauce
- [ ] 4 cups coleslaw
- [ ] 2 3/4 cups water, divided: 3/4 cup for deglazing and 2 cups for cooking

1. Season and brown pork

1. Mix 2 tsp hot paprika, 1 tsp mustard powder, 1/2 tsp ground cumin, 1 Tbsp light brown sugar, 2 tsp kosher salt, and 1/2 tsp black pepper.

2. Rub over 4 lb boneless pork shoulder, trimmed and cut into 6 pieces. Reserve the other 2 Tbsp brown sugar (3 Tbsp total) for the cooking liquid.

3. Use 2 tsp vegetable oil and the Instant Pot sauté setting to brown pork in batches. Remove pork.

2. Pressure-cook

1. Pour in 3/4 cup water and scrape up browned bits.

2. Whisk in 1/2 cup apple cider vinegar, 3 Tbsp tomato paste, the reserved 2 Tbsp brown sugar, and another 2 cups water (2 3/4 cups water total).

3. Return pork and cook on high pressure for 1 hour. Quick-release and transfer pork to a bowl.

3. Reduce, shred, and serve

1. Simmer cooking liquid on sauté until reduced by about half, skimming excess fat.

2. Shred pork with two forks. Stir in about 3 cups reduced cooking liquid, and adjust salt and vinegar to taste.

3. Divide pork among 12 hamburger potato buns. Serve with 1 cup barbecue sauce and 4 cups coleslaw, divided among the sandwiches.

Beef Jerky

Beef & pork | Dehydrator

Before you start

Equipment: covered glass dish, plastic wrap, and dehydrator. Marinate: about 8 hours or overnight. Dry: at least about 4 hours on the dehydrator's highest setting, as recorded in the saved recipe.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Marinade

- [ ] 1/4 cup low-sodium soy sauce [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp Worcestershire sauce [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp liquid smoke [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp brown sugar [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 tsp salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp black pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp meat tenderizer [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp garlic powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp onion powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp paprika [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 lb beef round steak, cut into thin strips

1. Slice and marinate

1. If slicing is difficult, partially freeze 2 lb beef round steak for about 30 minutes, then cut into thin strips.

2. Mix 1/4 cup low-sodium soy sauce, 2 Tbsp Worcestershire sauce, 2 Tbsp liquid smoke, 2 Tbsp brown sugar, 2 tsp salt, 1 tsp black pepper, 1 tsp meat tenderizer, 1 tsp garlic powder, 1 tsp onion powder, and 1 tsp paprika.

3. Toss beef strips with marinade in a glass dish. Cover and refrigerate about 8 hours or overnight.

2. Flatten and dry

1. Pound strips between plastic wrap to roughly 1/8-inch thickness.

2. Arrange in a single layer on dehydrator trays. Dry on the dehydrator's highest setting until done to your preferred texture, at least about 4 hours.

3. Finish

1. Cool and store airtight.

Bruschetta

Appetizers | Oven

Before you start

Equipment: baking sheet and mixing bowl. Oven: 400°F. Toast until golden, turning once. Add tomato topping just before serving.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Tomato topping

Bowl B - Dressing

- [ ] 1 loaf French bread, sliced about 1/4 inch thick
- [ ] 1 Tbsp extra-virgin olive oil, for bread
- [ ] 8 Roma tomatoes, diced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/3 cup chopped fresh basil [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 oz Parmesan, freshly grated [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 cloves garlic, minced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp balsamic vinegar [Bowl B]
- [ ] 2 tsp extra-virgin olive oil, for tomato mixture [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp kosher salt [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp freshly ground black pepper [Bowl B]

1. Toast bread

1. Heat the oven to 400°F.

2. Slice 1 loaf French bread about 1/4 inch thick. Use 1 Tbsp extra-virgin olive oil to lightly brush both sides of the slices.

3. Toast on a baking sheet until golden, turning once.

2. Mix topping while bread toasts

1. Combine 8 diced Roma tomatoes, 1/3 cup chopped fresh basil, 1 oz freshly grated Parmesan, and 2 minced garlic cloves.

2. Stir in 1 Tbsp balsamic vinegar, 2 tsp extra-virgin olive oil, 1/4 tsp kosher salt, and 1/4 tsp freshly ground black pepper.

3. Serve

1. Spoon the tomato mixture over toasted bread and serve immediately.

Cauliflower Chicken Fried Rice

Chicken | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Equipment: large skillet. Prep: dice chicken, slice green onions, mince garlic, and lightly beat the eggs before cooking.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Cooking oils

Bowl B - Peas, carrots, and green onions

- [ ] 2 Tbsp sesame oil [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp canola or vegetable oil [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 1/4 lb boneless skinless chicken breasts, diced
- [ ] 16 oz cauliflower rice (about 4 cups)
- [ ] 1 1/2 cups frozen peas and diced carrots [Bowl B]
- [ ] 3 green onions, sliced [Bowl B]
- [ ] 3 garlic cloves, minced
- [ ] 3 eggs, lightly beaten
- [ ] 1/3 cup reduced-sodium soy sauce
- [ ] Salt and black pepper, optional

1. Cook the chicken

1. Heat 2 Tbsp sesame oil and 2 Tbsp canola or vegetable oil in a large skillet over medium-high heat.

2. Add 1 1/4 lb diced boneless, skinless chicken breasts. Cook about 5 minutes, stirring as needed, then remove to a plate.

2. Cook vegetables and eggs

1. Add 16 oz cauliflower rice (about 4 cups) to the skillet and cook about 4 minutes.

2. Add 1 1/2 cups frozen peas and diced carrots and 3 sliced green onions. Cook about 2 minutes.

3. Add 3 minced garlic cloves and cook about 1 minute.

4. Push vegetables to one side. Pour 3 lightly beaten eggs into the open area and scramble until cooked, about 90 seconds.

3. Combine

1. Return chicken to the skillet. Add 1/3 cup reduced-sodium soy sauce and toss everything together, ensuring the chicken is cooked through.

2. Add optional salt and black pepper to taste and serve.

Cheesy Gruyere & Swiss Roasted Asparagus

Sides | Oven

Before you start

Equipment: baking sheet and broiler. Oven: 400°F, then broil. Roast: about 10 minutes before adding cheese.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Oil, lemon, and seasoning

Bowl B - Shredded cheeses

- [ ] 1 bunch large asparagus, trimmed
- [ ] 1 Tbsp olive oil [Bowl A]
- [ ] Salt and black pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] Juice and zest of 1 lemon [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 cup shredded Gruyère [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4 cup shredded Swiss cheese [Bowl B]

1. Season and roast

1. Heat the oven to 400°F.

2. Toss 1 bunch trimmed large asparagus with 1 Tbsp olive oil, the juice and zest of 1 lemon, and salt and black pepper to taste.

3. Arrange on a baking sheet and roast about 10 minutes.

2. Melt the cheese

1. Top with 1/2 cup shredded Gruyère and 1/4 cup shredded Swiss cheese.

2. Broil until the cheese is melted, bubbly, and golden. Serve immediately.

Chicken Caesar Smash Tacos

Chicken | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Makes: 8 tacos. Equipment: skillet, small pan, and mixing bowl. Prep: chop bacon, shred romaine, and measure the dressing before cooking.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Caesar dressing

Bowl B - Chicken seasonings

Bowl C - Fats for panko

Bowl D - Panko finishing ingredients

Caesar dressing:

- [ ] 3/4 cup whole-egg mayonnaise [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp grated Parmesan [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp lemon juice [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp Dijon mustard [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp minced garlic [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp Worcestershire sauce [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp black pepper [Bowl A]

Tacos:

- [ ] 7 oz bacon, chopped
- [ ] 1 lb ground chicken
- [ ] 1 tsp garlic powder [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 tsp onion powder [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 tsp sweet paprika [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp salt [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp black pepper [Bowl B]
- [ ] 8 small flour tortillas
- [ ] Olive oil, as needed

Crispy topping:

- [ ] 1 tsp olive oil [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp butter [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1/2 cup panko breadcrumbs
- [ ] 1/4 tsp salt [Bowl D]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp grated Parmesan [Bowl D]

To serve:

- [ ] 2 cups shredded romaine
- [ ] 1/4 cup grated Parmesan

1. Mix the dressing

1. Whisk together 3/4 cup whole-egg mayonnaise, 2 Tbsp grated Parmesan, 1 Tbsp lemon juice, 1 tsp Dijon mustard, 1/2 tsp minced garlic, 1 tsp Worcestershire sauce, 1/4 tsp salt, and 1/4 tsp black pepper. Set aside.

2. Cook the toppings

1. Cook 7 oz chopped bacon in a skillet until crisp. Drain and set aside.

2. In a small pan, heat 1 tsp olive oil with 1 Tbsp butter. Add 1/2 cup panko and toast 2-3 minutes, until golden. Stir in 1 Tbsp grated Parmesan and 1/4 tsp salt. Set aside.

3. Prepare and cook the tacos

1. Mix 1 lb ground chicken with 1 tsp garlic powder, 1 tsp onion powder, 1 tsp sweet paprika, 1/2 tsp salt, and 1/2 tsp black pepper.

2. Divide into 8 equal portions. Press one portion in a thin layer onto each of 8 small flour tortillas.

3. Lightly oil a skillet and heat over medium-high. Cook tortillas chicken-side down until the chicken is browned and cooked through. Flip briefly to warm and crisp the tortilla side.

4. Assemble

1. Divide 2 cups shredded romaine, the cooked bacon, prepared dressing, 1/4 cup grated Parmesan, and crispy panko among the tacos. Fold and serve immediately.

Chicken Cordon Bleu

Chicken | Oven

Before you start

Equipment: baking sheet, plastic wrap, and meat thermometer. Oven: 400°F. Plan ahead: chill rolls at least 30 minutes or up to a day; bake about 30 minutes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Mustard mayonnaise

- [ ] 4 boneless, skinless chicken breasts (about 2 lb), sliced horizontally into thin pieces and pounded evenly
- [ ] 8 thin slices ham
- [ ] 8 oz Swiss cheese
- [ ] Salt and black pepper
- [ ] 3 cups cornflakes, crushed (or breadcrumbs)
- [ ] 6 Tbsp butter, melted

Sauce:

- [ ] 1 cup mayonnaise [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1-2 tsp yellow mustard, to taste [Bowl A]

1. Fill and chill

1. Slice 4 boneless, skinless chicken breasts (about 2 lb total) horizontally into thin pieces. Pound to an even thinness.

2. Season with salt and black pepper. Divide 8 thin ham slices and 8 oz Swiss cheese among the chicken pieces, then roll each piece tightly.

3. Wrap the rolls snugly in plastic wrap. Refrigerate at least 30 minutes or up to a day.

2. Coat and bake

1. Heat the oven to 400°F and lightly grease a baking sheet.

2. Unwrap the rolls. Dip in 6 Tbsp melted butter, then coat thoroughly with 3 cups crushed cornflakes (or breadcrumbs).

3. Bake about 30 minutes, until the chicken reaches 165°F on a thermometer inserted into the chicken itself, not the filling.

3. Make the sauce

1. While the chicken bakes, stir together 1 cup mayonnaise and 1-2 tsp yellow mustard, to taste. Serve alongside the chicken.

Notes

Temperature clarification: the archived recipe listed about 160°F. This version uses USDA's 165°F endpoint for chicken. Reference: https://www.fsis.usda.gov/food-safety/safe-food-handling-and-preparation/food-safety-basics/safe-temperature-chart

Prep clarification needed: The saved recipe specifies 8 oz Swiss cheese but does not specify its cut or form. Keep that detail open rather than assuming slices or shreds.

Chicken Salad

Chicken | Sous vide

Before you start

Equipment: sous-vide bath, food-safe bag, and ice bath. Cook: 155°F for 1-4 hours; chill about 15 minutes. Alternative: use leftover cooked chicken.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Dressing base

- [ ] 1 3/4 lb bone-in, skin-on split chicken breasts
- [ ] Salt and black pepper
- [ ] 2 lemons, divided: 1 sliced for the bag; from the other, measure 1 Tbsp juice and 1 tsp zest for dressing
- [ ] 4 sprigs tarragon for the bag, plus 1 Tbsp minced tarragon for dressing
- [ ] 1/4 cup mayonnaise, plus more to taste [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp Dijon mustard, plus more to taste [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp minced parsley [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp minced chives [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 cup finely diced red onion [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 cup finely diced celery [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 garlic clove, minced [Bowl A]

1. Cook and chill chicken

1. Season 1 3/4 lb bone-in, skin-on split chicken breasts with salt and black pepper. Bag with slices from 1 of the 2 lemons and 4 tarragon sprigs.

2. Sous vide at 155°F for 1-4 hours. Chill the bag in an ice bath about 15 minutes. If using leftover cooked chicken, skip this cooking stage.

2. Make dressing

1. From the remaining lemon, measure 1 Tbsp juice and 1 tsp zest.

2. Mix the lemon juice and zest with 1/4 cup mayonnaise, 1 Tbsp Dijon mustard, 1 Tbsp minced tarragon, 1 Tbsp minced parsley, 1 Tbsp minced chives, 1/2 cup finely diced red onion, 1/2 cup finely diced celery, and 1 minced garlic clove.

3. Combine

1. Remove skin and bones from the chicken. Dice the meat into roughly 1/2-inch pieces and fold into the dressing.

2. Adjust salt, pepper, mayonnaise, Dijon, and lemon juice to taste. Serve with lettuce or as sandwiches.

Christmas Breakfast Casserole

Breakfast | Oven

Before you start

Equipment: 9×13-inch baking dish. Plan ahead: refrigerate at least 2 hours or overnight. Bake: 50-60 minutes at 350°F, then 20-30 minutes at 325°F. Rest: 10 minutes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Egg mixture

- [ ] 1 lb pork or maple breakfast sausage
- [ ] 1/2 tsp salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 6 eggs [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1-1 1/2 cups half-and-half [Bowl A]
- [ ] 6 slices white bread, toasted and cubed
- [ ] 2 cups shredded sharp cheddar

1. Assemble ahead

1. Grease a 9×13-inch baking dish. Brown 1 lb pork or maple breakfast sausage and drain well.
2. Whisk 6 eggs with 1/2 tsp salt and 1-1 1/2 cups half-and-half.
3. Stir in the cooked sausage, 6 slices white bread (toasted and cubed), and 2 cups shredded sharp cheddar.
4. Transfer to the baking dish, cover, and refrigerate at least 2 hours or overnight.

2. Bake and rest

1. Heat the oven to 350°F. Bake the casserole covered for 50-60 minutes.
2. Reduce the oven to 325°F. Uncover and bake another 20-30 minutes, until the center is set.
3. Rest about 10 minutes before serving.

Cobb Salad

Salads | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Equipment: serving platter and dressing jar. Before assembly: have 2 cooked chicken breasts, 2 hard-boiled eggs, and 6 oz cooked bacon ready. Dress just before serving.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Dressing

- [ ] 6 oz bacon, cooked and crumbled
- [ ] 1 medium head romaine lettuce (about 5 cups), chopped, rinsed, and thoroughly dried
- [ ] 2 cooked chicken breasts
- [ ] 2 hard-boiled eggs, quartered
- [ ] 1 large avocado, sliced
- [ ] 1 cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- [ ] 1/2 cup red onion, thinly sliced
- [ ] 1/2 cup crumbled blue cheese (or feta/goat cheese)
- [ ] 2 Tbsp chopped parsley or chives, optional

Dressing:

- [ ] 3 Tbsp balsamic vinegar [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp Dijon mustard [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 garlic clove, minced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/3 cup extra-virgin olive oil [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/8 tsp black pepper [Bowl A]

1. Prepare salad components

1. Cook and crumble 6 oz bacon if not already prepared. Hard-boil and quarter 2 eggs if not already prepared.

2. Chop, rinse, and thoroughly dry 1 medium head romaine (about 5 cups chopped). Spread on a platter.

2. Arrange salad

1. Arrange 2 cooked chicken breasts, the 2 quartered hard-boiled eggs, 1 sliced large avocado, 1 cup halved cherry tomatoes, 1/2 cup thinly sliced red onion, 1/2 cup crumbled blue cheese (or feta/goat cheese), and the cooked bacon in rows over the lettuce.

2. Add optional 2 Tbsp chopped parsley or chives.

3. Mix dressing

1. Shake 3 Tbsp balsamic vinegar, 1 Tbsp Dijon mustard, 1 minced garlic clove, 1/3 cup extra-virgin olive oil, 1/4 tsp salt, and 1/8 tsp black pepper in a jar.

2. Drizzle over salad just before serving, or serve on the side.

Corn Bread

Sides | Oven

Before you start

Equipment: 10-inch cast-iron skillet, heatproof cup, and two bowls. Oven: 425°F; preheat skillet inside. Bake: 20-25 minutes. Cool: about 10 minutes. Butter is divided after browning.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Dry ingredients

Bowl B - Eggs, sour cream, and buttermilk

- [ ] 7 Tbsp unsalted butter, to be browned and divided: about 1 Tbsp in skillet and about 6 Tbsp in heatproof cup; plus more for serving
- [ ] 1 cup fine yellow cornmeal [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 cup all-purpose flour [Bowl A]
- [ ] 4 Tbsp sugar [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp kosher salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 tsp baking powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp baking soda [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 eggs [Bowl B]
- [ ] 3/4 cup sour cream [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 cup cultured buttermilk [Bowl B]
- [ ] Honey, for serving

1. Heat skillet and brown butter

1. Heat the oven to 425°F with a 10-inch cast-iron skillet inside.

2. Brown 7 Tbsp unsalted butter in the hot skillet. Pour most into a heatproof cup, leaving about 1 Tbsp in the skillet.

2. Mix batter

1. Whisk 1 cup fine yellow cornmeal, 1 cup all-purpose flour, 4 Tbsp sugar, 1 tsp kosher salt, 2 tsp baking powder, and 1/4 tsp baking soda in a bowl.

2. In another bowl, whisk 2 eggs, 3/4 cup sour cream, and 1/2 cup cultured buttermilk. Slowly whisk in the browned butter from the cup (about 6 Tbsp).

3. Stir wet ingredients into dry just until combined.

3. Bake

1. Swirl the hot skillet to coat with its reserved 1 Tbsp browned butter. Add batter and lightly smooth the top.
2. Bake 20-25 minutes, until golden and a skewer comes out clean.
3. Cool about 10 minutes. Serve with extra butter and honey.

Corn Chowder (or Corn and Crab)

Soups | Instant Pot

Before you start

Equipment: Instant Pot. Pressure cook: 6 minutes on high, then quick-release. Allow extra time for the pot to reach pressure.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Aromatics

Bowl B - Seasonings

Bowl C - Cornstarch slurry

Bowl D - Corn and sugar

- [ ] 2 slices bacon (or about 2 Tbsp butter if omitting bacon)
- [ ] 1 large onion, diced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 3/4 cup diced carrots [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 cup diced celery [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 cup diced red bell pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] 4 cups chicken broth
- [ ] 1 lb potatoes, diced
- [ ] 1/2 tsp chopped fresh thyme [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 tsp salt [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp black pepper [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2-2 tsp hot sauce
- [ ] 3 cups corn [Bowl D]
- [ ] 1 tsp sugar [Bowl D]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp cornstarch [Bowl C]
- [ ] 3 Tbsp water [Bowl C]
- [ ] Cooked crab meat, optional, to taste
- [ ] 1/4-1 cup heavy cream

1. Sauté the bacon and vegetables

1. Set the Instant Pot to sauté. Cook 2 slices bacon until nearly crisp. If omitting bacon, use about 2 Tbsp butter instead.

2. Add 1 diced large onion, 3/4 cup diced carrots, 1/2 cup diced celery, and 1/2 cup diced red bell pepper. Sauté 2-3 minutes.

2. Pressure-cook

1. Cancel sauté. Pour in 4 cups chicken broth and thoroughly scrape the bottom to loosen any stuck bits.

2. Add 1 lb diced potatoes, 1/2 tsp chopped fresh thyme, 1 tsp salt, 1/2 tsp black pepper, and 1/2-2 tsp hot sauce.

3. Seal and cook on high pressure for 6 minutes. Quick-release the pressure.

3. Thicken and finish

1. Switch to sauté. Add 3 cups corn and 1 tsp sugar; simmer 1-2 minutes. Mash some potatoes in the pot to thicken the chowder.

2. For additional thickness, mix 2 Tbsp cornstarch with 3 Tbsp water. Stir in only as much of this slurry as needed.

3. If using cooked crab meat, add it to taste and heat through. Turn off the heat, then stir in 1/4-1 cup heavy cream to taste. Adjust seasoning and serve.

Corn on the Cob Boiled

Sides | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Equipment: large pot with lid. Cook corn: 5-7 minutes after adding it to the milk mixture.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Milk mixture

- [ ] 6 ears corn on the cob, shucked
- [ ] 6 cups water
- [ ] 2 cups milk [Bowl A]
- [ ] 8 Tbsp salted butter [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 cup honey or sugar [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp kosher salt [Bowl A]

1. Prepare cooking liquid

1. Shuck 6 ears corn and remove any remaining silk.

2. Bring 6 cups water to a boil over medium-high heat.

3. Lower the heat. Stir in 2 cups milk, 8 Tbsp salted butter, 1/4 cup honey or sugar, and 2 Tbsp kosher salt until butter melts and sweetener dissolves.

2. Cook corn

1. Add the 6 ears corn. Cover and cook 5-7 minutes.

2. Remove corn and serve immediately.

Crab Cakes

Appetizers | Air fryer

Before you start

Makes: 4 crab cakes. Equipment: mixing bowl and air fryer. Temperature: 370°F. Cook: 10 minutes. If mixture is loose, chill about 30 minutes before shaping.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Crab-cake binder and vegetables

- [ ] 8 oz lump crab meat
- [ ] 1/4 cup chopped red bell pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 green onions, chopped [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp mayonnaise [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp breadcrumbs [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp Dijon mustard [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp Old Bay seasoning [Bowl A]
- [ ] Oil for spraying
- [ ] Lemon wedge or squeeze of lemon

1. Mix and shape

1. Gently mix 8 oz lump crab meat, 1/4 cup chopped red bell pepper, 2 chopped green onions, 2 Tbsp mayonnaise, 2 Tbsp breadcrumbs, 1 Tbsp Dijon mustard, and 1 tsp Old Bay seasoning just until combined.

2. If the mixture feels loose, chill about 30 minutes before shaping. Form into 4 patties without packing tightly.

2. Air-fry

1. Place patties in the air-fryer basket and lightly spray tops with oil.

2. Air-fry at 370°F for 10 minutes. Finish with a lemon wedge or squeeze of lemon.

Notes

If the mixture feels loose, chilling it about 30 minutes before shaping can help it hold together.

Creamy Garlic Butter Tuscan Salmon

Seafood | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Equipment: large skillet. Sear salmon: about 3 minutes skin-side down, then 2-3 minutes on the other side. Finish in sauce: 1-2 minutes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Salmon seasonings

Bowl B - Parmesan and final sauce seasonings

Salmon:

- [ ] 4 salmon fillets, about 5-6 oz each
- [ ] 1/2 tsp garlic powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp paprika [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp black pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp olive oil

Sauce:

- [ ] 1 Tbsp unsalted butter
- [ ] 3-5 garlic cloves, minced
- [ ] 1/4 cup reduced-sodium chicken broth
- [ ] 1/2 cup chopped sun-dried tomatoes, drained
- [ ] 1 1/2 cups heavy cream
- [ ] 2 cups fresh baby spinach
- [ ] 1/3 cup freshly grated Parmesan [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp salt [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp black pepper [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp red pepper flakes, optional [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp chopped parsley, optional

1. Season and sear salmon

1. Pat dry 4 salmon fillets, about 5-6 oz each. Season with 1/2 tsp garlic powder, 1/2 tsp paprika, 1/2 tsp salt, and 1/2 tsp black pepper.

2. Heat 2 Tbsp olive oil in a large skillet. Sear salmon skin-side down about 3 minutes, flip, and cook another 2-3 minutes. Remove to a plate.

2. Make the sauce

1. Melt 1 Tbsp unsalted butter in the same skillet. Add 3-5 minced garlic cloves and cook about 1 minute. Pour in 1/4 cup reduced-sodium chicken broth and loosen the browned bits.

2. Add 1/2 cup chopped, drained sun-dried tomatoes and simmer 1-2 minutes.

3. Stir in 1 1/2 cups heavy cream and simmer gently 2-3 minutes.

4. Add 2 cups fresh baby spinach and cook until wilted. Stir in 1/3 cup freshly grated Parmesan, 1/2 tsp salt, 1/2 tsp black pepper, and optional 1/2 tsp red pepper flakes until smooth.

3. Finish

1. Return the salmon to the sauce and simmer 1-2 minutes, spooning sauce over the fish.

2. Garnish with optional 1 Tbsp chopped parsley and serve.

Espresso Martini

Drinks | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Equipment: cocktail shaker, ice, and chilled martini glass. Cool the espresso before mixing. Your preferred ratio is retained in the notes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Cocktail mixture; cool espresso first

- [ ] 2 oz vodka [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 oz brewed espresso, cooled [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 oz coffee liqueur [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 oz simple syrup [Bowl A]
- [ ] Coffee beans, optional garnish

1. Shake

1. Pour 2 oz vodka, 1 oz cooled brewed espresso, 1/2 oz coffee liqueur, and 1/2 oz simple syrup into a cocktail shaker.

2. Add ice and shake very vigorously until thoroughly chilled and foamy.

2. Serve

1. Strain immediately into a chilled martini glass. Garnish with optional coffee beans.

Notes

Personal note from Recipe Index: 2 vodka, 1 espresso, 1 Kahlúa.

The linked source uses 1/2 oz coffee liqueur and 1/2 oz simple syrup; the personal note reflects your preferred ratio.

Excellent Meatballs

Beef & pork | Oven

Before you start

Equipment: sauté pan and baking sheet. Oven: 350°F. Bake: about 15 minutes after browning. Plan ahead: cool the cooked onion mixture completely before mixing with meat.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Garlic and red pepper

Bowl B - Cheese, parsley, and breadcrumbs

- [ ] Extra-virgin olive oil
- [ ] 1 large onion, diced about 1/4 inch
- [ ] Salt
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves, chopped [Bowl A]
- [ ] Pinch crushed red pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 lb ground beef
- [ ] 1/2 lb ground veal
- [ ] 1/2 lb ground pork
- [ ] 2 large eggs
- [ ] 1 cup grated Parmigiano [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4 cup finely chopped Italian parsley [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 cup breadcrumbs [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 cup water
- [ ] Marinara sauce, for serving

1. Cook and cool the aromatics

1. Coat a large sauté pan with extra-virgin olive oil. Add 1 large onion, diced about 1/4 inch, and salt. Cook over medium-high heat 5-7 minutes, until very soft but not browned.

2. Add 2 chopped garlic cloves and a pinch of crushed red pepper. Cook 1-2 minutes, then let the mixture cool completely.

2. Mix and shape

1. Combine 1/2 lb ground beef, 1/2 lb ground veal, 1/2 lb ground pork, 2 large eggs, 1 cup grated Parmigiano, 1/4 cup finely chopped Italian parsley, and 1 cup breadcrumbs.

2. Mix in the cooled onion mixture and season generously with salt. Add 1/2 cup water and mix thoroughly; the mixture should be quite moist.

3. Cook a small tester patty and adjust seasoning if needed.

4. Heat the oven to 350°F. Shape meatballs slightly larger than golf balls.

3. Brown and bake

1. Brown the meatballs on all sides in olive oil over medium-high heat, working in batches.

2. Transfer to a baking sheet and bake about 15 minutes, until cooked through. Serve with marinara.

Notes

Make-ahead option from the saved recipe: cool the cooked meatballs and freeze for later.

Fettuccine Alfredo

Pasta & pizza | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Equipment: pasta pot and skillet. Sauce simmer: 5-8 minutes. Reserve pasta water before draining; Parmesan is divided.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Sauce seasonings

- [ ] 1 lb fettuccine
- [ ] 6 Tbsp butter
- [ ] 1 garlic clove, minced
- [ ] 1 1/2 cups heavy cream
- [ ] 1/4 tsp salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 1/4 cups shredded Parmesan, divided: about 5/8 cup for sauce; remaining 5/8 cup for pasta
- [ ] 1/4 tsp black pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp Italian parsley, chopped, optional

1. Cook pasta; start sauce while it boils

1. Cook 1 lb fettuccine in salted boiling water according to the package. Reserve a little pasta water before draining.

2. Melt 6 Tbsp butter over medium heat. Cook 1 minced garlic clove 1-2 minutes.

3. Stir in 1 1/2 cups heavy cream and simmer 5-8 minutes to reduce slightly.

2. Add cheese and combine

1. From 1 1/4 cups shredded Parmesan, whisk about half (5/8 cup) into the sauce until smooth and melted. Season with 1/4 tsp salt and 1/4 tsp black pepper.

2. Toss sauce with the drained pasta and remaining 5/8 cup Parmesan. Loosen with reserved pasta water as needed.

3. Garnish with optional 2 Tbsp Italian parsley.

Notes

Use freshly shredded refrigerated Parmesan for best melting.

Fried Rice

Basics | Instant Pot

Before you start

Equipment: Instant Pot. Start with about 5 cups chilled cooked rice, or cook 1 1/2 cups dry jasmine rice first. Rice: 4 minutes high pressure plus 10 minutes natural-release and cooling time.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Eggs and salt

Bowl B - Garlic and ginger

Bowl C - Soy sauce and sesame oil

- [ ] 1 1/2 cups uncooked jasmine rice (or about 5 cups cooked rice, chilled before frying)
- [ ] 1 1/2 cups water, only if cooking rice from dry
- [ ] 3 Tbsp oil, divided into two 1 1/2 Tbsp portions
- [ ] 4 eggs [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 cloves garlic, minced [Bowl B]
- [ ] 2-inch piece ginger, minced or grated [Bowl B]
- [ ] 10 oz frozen mixed vegetables
- [ ] 2 Tbsp low-sodium soy sauce [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1 1/2 tsp sesame oil [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1/3 cup green onions, sliced
- [ ] 1/4 tsp black pepper

1. Prepare rice

1. If starting with dry rice, pressure-cook 1 1/2 cups uncooked jasmine rice with 1 1/2 cups water on high for 4 minutes. Natural-release 10 minutes, then release any remaining pressure.

2. Chill the cooked rice before frying for best texture. If using about 5 cups chilled cooked rice, skip the pressure-cooking stage.

2. Scramble eggs and cook vegetables

1. Using sauté mode, heat 1 1/2 Tbsp oil (half of the 3 Tbsp total). Scramble 4 eggs with 1/2 tsp salt, then remove from the pot.

2. Add the remaining 1 1/2 Tbsp oil, 2 minced garlic cloves, and one minced or grated 2-inch piece ginger. Cook briefly.

3. Add 10 oz frozen mixed vegetables and stir-fry until heated.

3. Fry and finish

1. Add the chilled rice (about 5 cups) in batches. Fry, breaking up clumps.
2. Stir in 2 Tbsp low-sodium soy sauce and 1 1/2 tsp sesame oil.
3. Turn off the heat. Fold in the cooked eggs and 1/3 cup sliced green onions. Season with 1/4 tsp black pepper.

Notes

Chilled rice works much better than freshly cooked hot rice for fried rice.

Prep clarification needed: Cooking oil type is not specified in the saved recipe. Retain your usual choice; no type has been assumed. Ginger may be minced or grated, as written.

Garlic Parmesan Wings

Appetizers | Air fryer

Before you start

Equipment: air fryer and mixing bowl. Temperature: 400°F. Cook: 15 minutes, flip, then 5-8 minutes more. Use baking powder, not baking soda.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Wing coating

Bowl B - Garlic-Parmesan butter

- [ ] 2 lb chicken wings
- [ ] 1 Tbsp olive oil
- [ ] 1 Tbsp baking powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp kosher salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp garlic powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp onion powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp paprika [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp black pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] 5 Tbsp unsalted butter, melted [Bowl B]
- [ ] 4-5 garlic cloves, minced [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4 cup grated Parmesan [Bowl B]
- [ ] Chopped parsley, optional

1. Season wings

1. Pat 2 lb chicken wings dry and toss with 1 Tbsp olive oil.

2. Coat with 1 Tbsp baking powder, 1/2 tsp kosher salt, 1/2 tsp garlic powder, 1/2 tsp onion powder, 1/4 tsp paprika, and 1/4 tsp black pepper.

2. Air-fry

1. Arrange wings in a single layer in the air fryer. Cook at 400°F for 15 minutes.

2. Flip and cook another 5-8 minutes, until crisp and cooked through.

3. Make sauce and toss

1. While wings cook, combine 5 Tbsp melted unsalted butter, 4-5 minced garlic cloves, and 1/4 cup grated Parmesan.

2. Toss the hot wings with the sauce. Garnish with optional chopped parsley.

Gorgonzola Cream Sauce for Filet

Beef & pork | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Equipment: skillet and foil. Steaks: about 3-4 minutes per side, or to desired doneness. Make sauce while the filets rest. Butter is divided: 2 Tbsp for steaks and 2 Tbsp for sauce.

Ingredients

Keep these ingredients separate; follow the order in the directions.

For the filet:

- [ ] 2 Tbsp butter
- [ ] 2 filet mignon steaks, about 1-1 1/2 inches thick
- [ ] Salt and black pepper

For the sauce:

- [ ] 2 Tbsp butter
- [ ] 1 shallot, minced
- [ ] 1 garlic clove, minced
- [ ] 2 heaping Tbsp crumbled Gorgonzola
- [ ] 2-3 Tbsp heavy cream
- [ ] Salt and black pepper

1. Sear and rest filets

1. Season 2 filet mignon steaks, about 1-1 1/2 inches thick, with salt and black pepper.
2. Melt 2 Tbsp butter in a hot skillet. Sear steaks about 3-4 minutes per side, or to desired doneness.
3. Remove steaks and rest under foil while making the sauce.

2. Make sauce

1. Melt another 2 Tbsp butter. Cook 1 minced shallot about 2 minutes, then add 1 minced garlic clove and cook about 1 minute.
2. Stir in 2 heaping Tbsp crumbled Gorgonzola until it begins to melt.
3. Add 2-3 Tbsp heavy cream to reach the desired consistency. Season with salt and black pepper.
4. Spoon over the rested filets.

Grilled Chicken Breasts

Chicken | Grill

Before you start

Equipment: grill and thermometer. Brine: 15 minutes to 2 hours refrigerated. Grill: about 400°F, roughly 4 minutes per side to 165°F. Rest: 5 minutes. Use Morton's kosher salt for the stated brine quantity.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Brine

- [ ] 4 boneless, skinless chicken breasts (about 1 1/2 lb)
- [ ] 4 cups cold water [Bowl A]
- [ ] 4 Tbsp Morton's kosher salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 tsp garlic powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp dried thyme [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp vegetable or grapeseed oil

1. Prepare and brine

1. Cut 4 boneless, skinless chicken breasts (about 1 1/2 lb total) horizontally in half. Pound pieces to an even thickness.

2. Dissolve 4 Tbsp Morton's kosher salt in 4 cups cold water. Stir in 2 tsp garlic powder and 1 tsp dried thyme.

3. Submerge chicken and refrigerate 15 minutes to 2 hours.

2. Heat grill and cook

1. Remove chicken, pat dry, and discard brine. Let chicken sit at room temperature 10-15 minutes while the grill heats.

2. Use 2 Tbsp vegetable or grapeseed oil to oil the cold grates, then preheat for direct cooking over medium-high heat, about 400°F.

3. Grill chicken in a single layer about 4 minutes per side, until browned and the center reaches 165°F.

4. Rest 5 minutes before serving.

Notes

The salt quantity is specifically for Morton's kosher salt; other salts may require a different amount.

Ham and Cheese Sliders

Basics | Oven

Before you start

Makes: 12 sliders. Equipment: 11×8-inch baking dish and foil. Oven: 350°F. Bake covered: 25 minutes; uncovered: 5-10 minutes. Make-ahead option in notes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Honey-mustard mayonnaise

Bowl B - Butter topping

For the sliders:

- [ ] 12 Hawaiian sweet rolls
- [ ] 1/4 cup mayonnaise [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp Dijon mustard [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp honey [Bowl A]
- [ ] 12 oz sliced Swiss cheese
- [ ] 12 oz thinly sliced deli ham

For the topping:

- [ ] 6 Tbsp unsalted butter, melted [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp Dijon mustard [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp poppy seeds [Bowl B]
- [ ] 2 tsp dried minced onion [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp garlic powder [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp Worcestershire sauce [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp kosher salt [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/8 tsp black pepper [Bowl B]

1. Assemble sliders

1. Heat the oven to 350°F and grease an 11×8-inch baking dish.

2. Slice 12 attached Hawaiian sweet rolls horizontally into top and bottom slabs. Put the bottom slab in the dish.

3. Mix 1/4 cup mayonnaise, 2 Tbsp Dijon mustard, and 1 Tbsp honey. Spread over both cut surfaces.

4. Layer 6 oz sliced Swiss cheese, all 12 oz thinly sliced deli ham, and the remaining 6 oz Swiss (12 oz cheese total). Replace roll tops.

2. Mix topping

1. Mix 6 Tbsp melted unsalted butter, 1 Tbsp Dijon mustard, 1 Tbsp poppy seeds, 2 tsp dried minced onion, 1/2 tsp garlic powder, 1/2 tsp Worcestershire sauce, 1/4 tsp kosher salt, and 1/8 tsp black pepper.

2. Brush the topping over the rolls.

3. Bake

1. Cover tightly with foil and bake 25 minutes.

2. Uncover and bake another 5-10 minutes, until tops are crisp and golden. Cut into individual sliders and serve.

Notes

The assembled sliders can be refrigerated up to a day before baking; add the butter topping just before they go into the oven.

High-Protein Ravioli Casserole

Pasta & pizza | Oven

Before you start

Equipment: skillet, mixing bowl, and 9×13-inch baking dish. Oven: 400°F. Bake covered: 25-30 minutes, until hot and bubbly.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Meat seasonings

Bowl B - Cheese filling

- [ ] 24 oz fresh ravioli
- [ ] 32 oz marinara sauce
- [ ] 2 cups cottage cheese [Bowl B]
- [ ] 16 oz ricotta [Bowl B]
- [ ] 2 cups shredded mozzarella
- [ ] 1/3 cup grated Parmesan
- [ ] 1 lb ground meat
- [ ] 1 tsp cumin [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp chili powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp paprika [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp garlic powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp onion powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] Salt and pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] Optional: basil, red pepper flakes, or spinach

1. Make meat sauce and cheese filling

1. Heat the oven to 400°F.

2. Brown 1 lb ground meat. Season with 1 tsp cumin, 1 tsp chili powder, 1/2 tsp paprika, 1/2 tsp garlic powder, 1/2 tsp onion powder, and salt and pepper to taste. Stir in 32 oz marinara sauce.

3. Mix 2 cups cottage cheese with 16 oz ricotta. Season to taste and fold in optional spinach. Divide this mixture into two equal portions.

2. Layer

1. Spread about 1 cup meat sauce in the baking dish. Add 12 oz fresh ravioli (half of the 24 oz), half the cottage cheese-ricotta mixture, and 1 cup shredded mozzarella.

2. Add the remaining meat sauce, remaining 12 oz ravioli, remaining cheese mixture, and remaining 1 cup mozzarella. Finish with 1/3 cup grated Parmesan.

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3. Bake and serve

1. Cover and bake 25-30 minutes, until hot and bubbly. Let cool briefly before serving.
2. Add optional basil or red pepper flakes to taste.

Notes

Layering clarification: use half of the full cottage cheese-ricotta mixture in each layer. The source's longer instructions specify halves; its condensed recipe card says 1 cup per layer, which leaves some filling unused.

Prep clarification needed: The optional spinach has no quantity or prep state specified. Retain the optional amount and prepare it to your preference.

Honey Lemon Salmon

Seafood | Oven

Before you start

Equipment: foil-lined baking sheet and broiler. Oven: 375°F, then broil. Bake about 15 minutes; broil 5-10 minutes. Optional marinating: 10-15 minutes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Honey-lemon butter; divide after mixing

Bowl B - Seasonings

- [ ] 1-1 1/4 lb skin-on salmon fillet
- [ ] 1 lemon, thinly sliced
- [ ] 1/2 cup unsalted butter, melted [Bowl A]
- [ ] 3-4 Tbsp honey [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2-3 Tbsp fresh lemon juice [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp kosher salt, or to taste [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp black pepper, or to taste [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp chopped fresh parsley, optional

1. Prepare salmon and divided sauce

1. Heat the oven to 375°F. Line a baking sheet with enough foil to form a packet.

2. Place 1-1 1/4 lb skin-on salmon skin-side down. Nestle 1 thinly sliced lemon underneath and around it.

3. Mix 1/2 cup melted unsalted butter, 3-4 Tbsp honey, and 2-3 Tbsp fresh lemon juice. Pour about two-thirds over the salmon and reserve the other third.

4. Season with 1 tsp kosher salt and 1/2 tsp black pepper, or to taste. Seal the foil packet. If convenient, let marinate 10-15 minutes.

2. Bake and finish

1. Bake about 15 minutes. Open the packet and spoon on some reserved sauce if desired.

2. Broil 5-10 minutes, until the top is browned to your liking.

3. Garnish with optional 1 Tbsp chopped fresh parsley and serve with any remaining reserved sauce.

Hungarian Mushroom Soup

Soups | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Equipment: soup pot and separate saucepan. Simmer mushrooms: about 15 minutes. Thicken milk mixture: about 10 minutes; final simmer: 10-15 minutes. Stock and dill are divided.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Paprika and tamari

Bowl B - Final sour cream mixture; add reserved dill and salt

- [ ] 12 oz mushrooms, sliced
- [ ] 2 cups chopped onions
- [ ] 2 Tbsp butter
- [ ] 3 Tbsp flour
- [ ] 1 cup milk
- [ ] 2 tsp dill, divided into two 1 tsp portions
- [ ] 1 Tbsp Hungarian paprika [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp tamari or soy sauce [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp salt, divided as directed
- [ ] 2 cups stock, divided as directed
- [ ] 2 tsp lemon juice [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4 cup chopped parsley
- [ ] Black pepper to taste [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 cup sour cream [Bowl B]

1. Cook mushrooms

1. Measure 2 cups stock. Use a little of it to sauté 2 cups chopped onions with some of the total 1 tsp salt, until softened.

2. Add 12 oz sliced mushrooms, 1 tsp dill (half of the 2 tsp), 1/2 cup stock from the measured total, 1 Tbsp tamari or soy sauce, and 1 Tbsp Hungarian paprika.

3. Cover and simmer about 15 minutes.

2. Make the milk mixture

1. In a separate saucepan, melt 2 Tbsp butter. Whisk in 3 Tbsp flour and cook briefly.

2. Gradually whisk in 1 cup milk. Cook over low heat about 10 minutes, until thickened.

3. Combine and finish

1. Stir the milk mixture into the mushrooms with all the stock remaining from the original 2 cups. Cover and simmer 10-15 minutes.

2. Just before serving, stir in 2 tsp lemon juice, 1/2 cup sour cream, remaining 1 tsp dill, remaining salt from the original 1 tsp (to taste), and black pepper to taste.

3. Garnish with 1/4 cup chopped parsley.

Instant Pot Broccoli Cheddar Soup

Soups | Instant Pot

Before you start

Equipment: Instant Pot and small bowl. High pressure: 4 minutes, then quick-release. Allow extra time for the pot to reach pressure.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Prepared vegetables

Bowl B - Dry seasonings

Bowl C - Cornstarch slurry

Bowl D - Cream and cheddar

- [ ] 2 Tbsp butter
- [ ] 1 small yellow onion, diced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 head broccoli, chopped small (about 3 cups florets) [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 cup shredded carrots [Bowl A]
- [ ] 32 oz chicken or vegetable broth
- [ ] 1/2 tsp black pepper [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 tsp kosher salt [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp red pepper flakes [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4 cup cold water [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1/4 cup cornstarch [Bowl C]
- [ ] 2 cups heavy cream [Bowl D]
- [ ] 3 cups shredded sharp cheddar [Bowl D]

1. Pressure-cook vegetables

1. Add 2 Tbsp butter, 1 diced small yellow onion, 1 head broccoli chopped small (about 3 cups florets), 1 cup shredded carrots, and 32 oz chicken or vegetable broth to the Instant Pot.

2. Add 1/2 tsp black pepper, 1 tsp kosher salt, and 1/4 tsp red pepper flakes.

3. Cook on high pressure 4 minutes, then quick-release.

2. Thicken and add dairy

1. Whisk 1/4 cup cold water with 1/4 cup cornstarch until smooth.

2. Switch the pot to sauté and stir in the slurry.

3. Stir in 2 cups heavy cream and 3 cups shredded sharp cheddar. Cook gently until cheese melts and soup thickens. Adjust seasoning and serve.

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Instant Pot French Onion Soup

Soups | Instant Pot

Before you start

Equipment: Instant Pot and oven-safe serving bowls. Onion pressure cook: 20 minutes, then quick-release; caramelize 22-30 minutes. Soup pressure setting: 0 minutes, then natural-release 20 minutes. Oven: 450°F; finish 6-8 minutes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Soup aromatics and sauces

Bowl B - Stocks

- [ ] 4 lb onions (mostly yellow onions plus shallots), sliced; reserve about 1/2 lb for later
- [ ] 6 Tbsp unsalted butter
- [ ] 1/2 tsp baking soda
- [ ] 1/4 cup dry white wine
- [ ] 3 garlic cloves, minced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp soy sauce [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp fish sauce (or additional soy sauce) [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 bay leaf [Bowl A]
- [ ] 3 sprigs fresh thyme or 1 tsp dried thyme [Bowl A]
- [ ] 4 cups unsalted beef stock [Bowl B]
- [ ] 4 cups unsalted chicken stock [Bowl B]
- [ ] Kosher salt to taste
- [ ] French baguette, sliced 3/4-1 inch thick
- [ ] 4 oz grated Gruyère

1. Cook and caramelize onions

1. From 4 lb sliced onions (mostly yellow onions plus shallots), reserve about 1/2 lb for later.

2. On Sauté More, melt 6 Tbsp unsalted butter. Add the shallots and remaining yellow onions (about 3 1/2 lb total). Stir in 1/2 tsp baking soda, not baking powder, and sauté about 5 minutes.

3. Pressure-cook onions on high for 20 minutes, then quick-release.

4. Reserve the released onion liquid separately. Sauté the onions about 22-30 minutes, until deeply golden and caramelized.

2. Build the soup

1. Add 1/4 cup dry white wine and thoroughly scrape the bottom to loosen stuck bits.

2. Add 3 minced garlic cloves, 1 Tbsp soy sauce, 1 Tbsp fish sauce (or additional soy sauce), 1 bay leaf, 3 fresh thyme sprigs (or 1 tsp dried thyme), the reserved 1/2 lb onions, and reserved onion liquid.

3. Add 4 cups unsalted beef stock and 4 cups unsalted chicken stock. Set high pressure to 0 minutes. Let pressure release naturally 20 minutes, then release the remainder.

3. Add bread and cheese

1. Heat the oven to 450°F. Season soup with kosher salt to taste. For more body, simmer on sauté 5-10 minutes.

2. Ladle into oven-safe bowls. Top with French baguette slices, 3/4-1 inch thick, and divide 4 oz grated Gruyère among the bowls.

3. Bake 6-8 minutes, until cheese is melted and browned.

Notes

Use baking soda, not baking powder.

The soup freezes well without the bread topping.

Instant Pot Hummus

Appetizers | Instant Pot

Before you start

Equipment: Instant Pot and blender. Optional soak: 8-16 hours. High pressure: 60 minutes unsoaked or 15 minutes soaked. Natural-release: 20 minutes, plus time to reach pressure.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Pressure-cooking aromatics

Bowl B - Lemon-garlic soak

- [ ] 1 cup (225 g) dried chickpeas
- [ ] 1 whole head garlic, crushed [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 bay leaves [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 onion, halved [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp fine salt if chickpeas are soaked; 1 1/2 tsp if unsoaked
- [ ] 4 cups water
- [ ] 1 tsp ground cumin
- [ ] 6 garlic cloves, crushed [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 cup tahini
- [ ] 1/4 cup fresh lemon juice [Bowl B]
- [ ] Extra-virgin olive oil, parsley, cumin, or paprika for serving, optional

1. Prepare and pressure-cook chickpeas

1. Rinse 1 cup (225 g) dried chickpeas. Optional: soak 8-16 hours, then rinse and drain.

2. Add chickpeas, 1 crushed whole garlic head, 2 bay leaves, 1 halved onion, and 4 cups water to the Instant Pot.

3. Add 1 tsp fine salt for soaked chickpeas or 1 1/2 tsp for unsoaked chickpeas.

4. Cook on high pressure 15 minutes if soaked or 60 minutes if unsoaked. Natural-release for 20 minutes, then release any remaining pressure before opening.

2. Prepare lemon-garlic mixture while pressure releases

1. Soak 6 crushed garlic cloves in 1/4 cup fresh lemon juice for 20-30 minutes.

3. Blend

1. Discard the cooked onion and bay leaves. Drain chickpeas and cooked garlic, reserving the cooking liquid.

2. Blend the lemon-garlic mixture, hot chickpeas, cooked garlic, 1 tsp ground cumin, and about 3/4 cup reserved cooking liquid until very smooth. Add more cooking liquid for thinner hummus.

3. Stir the purée into 1 cup tahini. Adjust salt to taste.

4. If serving immediately, add a little extra-virgin olive oil. Garnish with optional parsley, cumin, or paprika.

Notes

Homemade hummus keeps about one week refrigerated.

Lemon Garlic Salmon

Seafood | Air fryer

Before you start

Equipment: air fryer. Temperature: 390°F. Cook: 8-10 minutes, depending on thickness and doneness; rest 2 minutes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Garlic butter

Bowl B - Dry seasonings

- [ ] 1 Tbsp melted butter [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp minced garlic [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 center-cut salmon fillets, 6 oz each, skin on
- [ ] 1/4 tsp lemon-pepper seasoning [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/8 tsp dried parsley [Bowl B]
- [ ] Cooking spray
- [ ] 3 thin lemon slices, halved

1. Season

1. Preheat the air fryer to 390°F. Mix 1 Tbsp melted butter with 1/2 tsp minced garlic.
2. Pat dry 2 skin-on, center-cut salmon fillets, 6 oz each. Brush with the garlic butter.
3. Season with 1/4 tsp lemon-pepper seasoning and 1/8 tsp dried parsley, divided between the fillets.

2. Air-fry

1. Lightly coat the basket with cooking spray. Place salmon skin-side down.
2. Halve 3 thin lemon slices and divide the 6 half-slices between the fillets.
3. Air-fry 8-10 minutes, depending on thickness and preferred doneness. Rest 2 minutes before serving.

Lemon Pepper Chicken

Chicken | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Equipment: skillet. Chicken: about 5 minutes per side, until cooked through. Sauce: 3-5 minutes to reduce after adding lemon juice.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Seasoned flour

- [ ] 2 boneless, skinless chicken breasts (about 1.3 lb), sliced horizontally into thin cutlets
- [ ] 2 Tbsp all-purpose flour [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp lemon-pepper seasoning [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp cooking oil
- [ ] 1 garlic clove, minced
- [ ] 1/2 cup chicken broth
- [ ] 1 Tbsp butter
- [ ] 1 tsp lemon juice
- [ ] 1 Tbsp chopped parsley, optional
- [ ] 1/8 tsp black pepper

1. Prepare and cook chicken

1. Slice 2 boneless, skinless chicken breasts (about 1.3 lb total) horizontally into thin cutlets.

2. Mix 2 Tbsp all-purpose flour with 1 Tbsp lemon-pepper seasoning. Coat both sides of the chicken.

3. Heat 1 Tbsp cooking oil in a skillet over medium heat. Cook the chicken about 5 minutes per side, until browned and cooked through. Remove to a plate.

2. Make the pan sauce

1. Add 1 Tbsp butter and 1 minced garlic clove to the skillet. Cook about 1 minute.

2. Pour in 1/2 cup chicken broth and scrape up the browned bits. Add 1 tsp lemon juice; simmer 3-5 minutes to reduce slightly.

3. Return the chicken to the skillet and spoon sauce over it. Finish with 1/8 tsp black pepper and, if desired, 1 Tbsp chopped parsley.

London Broil

Beef & pork | Sous vide

Before you start

Equipment: sous-vide bath, food-safe bag, ice bath, saucepan, and skillet. Salt rest: 30-90 minutes. Source setting: 132°F for 7 hours; add about 1 hour from frozen. Your 138°F preference is retained in the notes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Marinade

- [ ] 2-3 lb London broil (top round or flank steak)
- [ ] 1 tsp garlic powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp soy sauce [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp brown sugar [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp Dijon mustard [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp Worcestershire sauce [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp rice vinegar [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 tsp salt

1. Season and bag

1. Heat the bath to 132°F for the source's medium-rare setting.

2. Season 2-3 lb London broil (top round or flank steak) on both sides with 2 tsp salt. Rest 30-90 minutes.

3. Mix 1 tsp garlic powder, 2 Tbsp soy sauce, 2 Tbsp brown sugar, 1 Tbsp Dijon mustard, 1 Tbsp Worcestershire sauce, and 1 Tbsp rice vinegar. Seal beef with this sauce.

2. Cook and make glaze

1. Sous vide for 7 hours; add about 1 hour if cooking from frozen.

2. Chill the sealed bag in an ice bath for 10 minutes. Remove beef, pat very dry, and reserve the bag juices.

3. Simmer reserved bag juices 3-4 minutes to reduce into a glaze.

3. Sear and serve

1. Sear beef in a smoking-hot skillet about 1 minute per side.

2. Slice thinly against the grain and serve with the reduced glaze.

Notes

Personal note from Recipe Index: try 138°F for 7 hours.

The source recipe uses 132°F for medium-rare and suggests 133-140°F for medium.

Mashed Potatoes

Sides | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Equipment: pot, colander, and ricer or potato masher. Simmer: 15-25 minutes, until very tender. Mix gently to avoid gluey potatoes.

Ingredients

Keep these ingredients separate; follow the order in the directions.

- [ ] 2 1/2 lb russet potatoes, cut into even chunks
- [ ] 4 Tbsp unsalted butter
- [ ] 3/4 cup heavy cream
- [ ] Kosher salt and freshly ground black pepper

1. Cook and drain

1. Put 2 1/2 lb russet potatoes, cut into even chunks, in a pot. Cover with well-salted cold water by about 2 inches.
2. Bring to a boil, reduce to a simmer, and cook 15-25 minutes, until very tender.
3. Drain thoroughly and return potatoes to the pot.

2. Mash - choose your method

1. With a ricer: rice the potatoes, then gently stir in 4 Tbsp unsalted butter and 3/4 cup heavy cream.
2. With a masher instead: melt 4 Tbsp unsalted butter, add to the potatoes, and mash. Then stir in 3/4 cup heavy cream and about 1 tsp salt.
3. Mix only until creamy. Adjust kosher salt and freshly ground black pepper to taste and serve hot.

Notes

The source recommends full-fat butter and heavy cream and warns that over-mixing can make mashed potatoes gluey.

Mexican Rice Instant Pot

Sides | Instant Pot

Before you start

Equipment: Instant Pot. High pressure: 3 minutes for firmer rice or 4 minutes for softer rice. Natural-release: 10 minutes. Allow extra time for the pot to reach pressure.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Vegetables and seasonings for pressure cooking

- [ ] 1 1/2 cups long-grain white rice
- [ ] 1/4 cup vegetable or canola oil
- [ ] 1 tsp minced garlic [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 medium onion, finely diced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 cup tomato sauce, or 2 puréed tomatoes [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 tomato bouillon cubes, finely chopped, or 2 tsp granulated [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 carrot, diced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 1/2 cups water
- [ ] 1/3 cup frozen peas

1. Rinse and toast rice

1. Rinse 1 1/2 cups long-grain white rice until the water runs clear. Drain well.

2. Set the Instant Pot to sauté. Heat 1/4 cup vegetable or canola oil. Fry the rice, stirring often, about 5 minutes, until lightly golden.

2. Add liquid and pressure-cook

1. Add 1 tsp minced garlic, 1/4 finely diced medium onion, 1/4 cup tomato sauce (or 2 puréed tomatoes), 1/4 tsp salt, 2 finely chopped tomato bouillon cubes (or 2 tsp granulated bouillon), and 1 diced carrot.

2. Stir in 1 1/2 cups water until the bouillon dissolves. Turn off sauté and seal the lid.

3. Cook on high pressure for 3 minutes for firmer rice or 4 minutes for softer rice. Let pressure release naturally for 10 minutes, then release any remaining pressure before opening.

3. Finish

1. Add 1/3 cup frozen peas and fluff gently with a fork rather than stirring.

2. Replace the lid and let the rice rest a few minutes before serving.

Mongolian Beef

Beef & pork | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Equipment: saucepan and large skillet. Oil is divided: sauce uses 1 Tbsp olive + 1 Tbsp sesame; beef uses 2 Tbsp olive + 1 Tbsp sesame.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Garlic and ginger

Bowl B - Sauce liquids and sugar

- [ ] 1 lb flank steak, sliced into bite-size strips
- [ ] 1/4 cup cornstarch
- [ ] 3 Tbsp olive oil, divided: 1 Tbsp for sauce; 2 Tbsp for beef
- [ ] 2 Tbsp sesame oil, divided: 1 Tbsp for sauce; 1 Tbsp for beef
- [ ] 3-4 cloves garlic, minced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1-2 tsp fresh ginger, minced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 cup reduced-sodium soy sauce [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 cup water [Bowl B]
- [ ] 3/4 cup packed brown sugar, or to taste [Bowl B]
- [ ] Sliced green onions and sesame seeds, for garnish

1. Coat beef and make sauce

1. Toss 1 lb flank steak, sliced into bite-size strips, with 1/4 cup cornstarch until coated.

2. Heat 1 Tbsp olive oil and 1 Tbsp sesame oil in a saucepan. Cook 3-4 minced garlic cloves and 1-2 tsp minced fresh ginger about 1 minute.

3. Add 1/2 cup reduced-sodium soy sauce, 1/2 cup water, and 3/4 cup packed brown sugar, or to taste. Boil 2-3 minutes, then simmer about 5 minutes to reduce slightly.

2. Cook beef and combine

1. Heat the remaining 2 Tbsp olive oil and 1 Tbsp sesame oil in a large skillet.

2. Sear the coated steak over medium-high to high heat about 5-7 minutes, turning as needed.

3. Pour the prepared sauce over the steak. Simmer several minutes, until thickened and the beef is well coated.

4. Garnish with sliced green onions and sesame seeds. Serve hot.

P.F. Chang's Chicken Lettuce Wraps

Chicken | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Equipment: large skillet. Prep: finely dice the onion and drained water chestnuts; mince garlic and slice green onions before heating the pan.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Cooking oils

Bowl B - Sauce mixture

Bowl C - Garlic and ginger

Bowl D - Final seasonings

- [ ] 1 Tbsp olive oil [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp sesame oil [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 lb ground chicken
- [ ] 1 medium-large sweet or yellow onion, finely diced
- [ ] 1/3 cup hoisin sauce [Bowl B]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp reduced-sodium soy sauce [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp rice vinegar [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp Asian chili-garlic sauce, or to taste [Bowl B]
- [ ] 3 garlic cloves, minced [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1 tsp ground ginger or 2 tsp freshly grated ginger [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1 (8 oz) can water chestnuts, drained and finely diced
- [ ] 2-3 green onions, thinly sliced
- [ ] 1/2 tsp salt, or to taste [Bowl D]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp black pepper, or to taste [Bowl D]
- [ ] Butter lettuce leaves, for serving

1. Cook chicken and sauce

1. Heat 1 Tbsp olive oil and 1 Tbsp sesame oil in a large skillet over medium-high heat.

2. Add 1 lb ground chicken. Break into crumbles and cook through.

3. Add 1 finely diced medium-large sweet or yellow onion, 1/3 cup hoisin sauce, 2 Tbsp reduced-sodium soy sauce, 1 Tbsp rice vinegar, and 1 Tbsp Asian chili-garlic sauce (or to taste). Cook about 5 minutes, until the onion softens and most liquid is absorbed.

2. Finish and serve

1. Add 3 minced garlic cloves and 1 tsp ground ginger (or 2 tsp freshly grated ginger). Cook about 1 minute.

2. Stir in one 8 oz can water chestnuts, drained and finely diced, and 2-3 thinly sliced green onions. Cook about 2 minutes.

3. Season with 1/2 tsp salt and 1/2 tsp black pepper, or to taste. Adjust hoisin or soy sauce to taste if needed.

4. Spoon into butter lettuce leaves and serve.

Parmesan Roasted Potatoes

Sides | Oven

Before you start

Equipment: 9×13-inch baking pan. Start with a cold oven; heat to 400°F with butter in the pan. Bake potatoes uncovered: about 40 minutes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Parmesan and seasoning; add 2 Tbsp herb seasoning

- [ ] 1/2 cup butter
- [ ] 1/3 cup grated Parmesan [Bowl A]
- [ ] 3 Tbsp herb seasoning, divided: 2 Tbsp for Parmesan mixture; 1 Tbsp for tops
- [ ] 1 tsp salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp black pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 lb red potatoes, washed, halved, and cut surfaces scored
- [ ] Nonstick cooking spray

1. Melt butter and prepare potatoes

1. Put 1/2 cup butter in a 9×13-inch baking pan. Place in a cold oven and heat to 400°F so the butter melts as the oven preheats.

2. Halve 2 lb washed red potatoes and score their cut surfaces.

2. Season and bake

1. Mix 1/3 cup grated Parmesan, 2 Tbsp herb seasoning, 1 tsp salt, and 1/2 tsp black pepper. Sprinkle evenly over the melted butter.

2. Place potatoes cut-side down on the seasoned butter. Lightly coat tops with nonstick spray and sprinkle with the remaining 1 Tbsp herb seasoning (3 Tbsp total).

3. Bake uncovered about 40 minutes, until tender with a crisp Parmesan crust.

Pasta Salad

Sides | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Equipment: large pot, colander, and mixing bowl. Pasta: about 10-12 minutes. Rinse and drain well before mixing; optional chilling before serving.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Dressing

Bowl B - Prepared vegetables and olives

- [ ] 1 lb tri-colored spiral pasta
- [ ] 1 (16 oz) bottle Italian-style salad dressing [Bowl A]
- [ ] 6 Tbsp salad seasoning mix [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 cups cherry tomatoes, diced [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 green bell pepper, chopped [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 red bell pepper, diced [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 yellow bell pepper, chopped [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 (2.25 oz) can black olives, chopped [Bowl B]

1. Cook pasta and mix dressing

1. Cook 1 lb tri-colored spiral pasta in lightly salted boiling water about 10-12 minutes, until tender but still firm. Rinse under cold water and drain well.

2. Whisk one 16 oz bottle Italian-style salad dressing with 6 Tbsp salad seasoning mix.

2. Combine

1. Combine cooled pasta with 2 cups diced cherry tomatoes, 1 chopped green bell pepper, 1 diced red bell pepper, 1/2 chopped yellow bell pepper, and one 2.25 oz can chopped black olives.

2. Pour the prepared dressing over the salad and toss thoroughly. Chill before serving if desired.

Pepperoni Garlic Knots

Pasta & pizza | Oven

Before you start

Makes: 24 knots. Equipment: 10-inch cast-iron skillet. Rise: until doubled, about 4 hours at room temperature or 12-16 hours refrigerated. Oven: 425°F. Bake: 25-30 minutes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Garlic and red pepper

Bowl B - Fresh herbs

- [ ] 2 Tbsp unsalted butter
- [ ] 2 Tbsp extra-virgin olive oil, plus more for finishing
- [ ] 4 oz pepperoni, cut small
- [ ] Pinch red pepper flakes [Bowl A]
- [ ] 6 garlic cloves, minced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 cup chopped parsley [Bowl B]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp minced chives, optional [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 cup grated Parmesan, plus more for finishing
- [ ] Flour for dusting
- [ ] 1 lb pizza dough
- [ ] 1/4 cup grated Pecorino Romano
- [ ] Pizza sauce, for serving

1. Make pepperoni-garlic coating

1. Melt 2 Tbsp unsalted butter with 2 Tbsp extra-virgin olive oil in a 10-inch cast-iron skillet.

2. Add 4 oz pepperoni, cut small, and cook about 2 minutes, until crisp. Add a pinch of red pepper flakes and 6 minced garlic cloves; cook about 1 minute.

3. Stir in 1/4 cup chopped parsley and optional 2 Tbsp minced chives. Transfer to a bowl and mix in 1/2 cup grated Parmesan.

2. Shape and rise

1. Using flour for dusting, divide 1 lb pizza dough into two halves. Stretch each half into roughly an 8×4-inch rectangle and cut each into 12 strips.

2. Tie the 24 strips into knots. Toss thoroughly with the prepared pepperoni-garlic coating and arrange in the skillet.

3. Drizzle lightly with additional olive oil, cover, and let rise until doubled: about 4 hours at room temperature or 12-16 hours refrigerated.

3. Bake and serve

1. Heat the oven to 425°F. Sprinkle knots with 1/4 cup grated Pecorino Romano.
2. Bake 25-30 minutes, until golden and crisp.
3. Brush hot knots with additional olive oil, sprinkle with extra Parmesan, and serve with warm pizza sauce.

Pepperoni Pizza Sliders

Pasta & pizza | Oven

Before you start

Makes: 12 sliders. Equipment: lined, greased 9×13-inch pan. Oven: 375°F. Stand: 5-10 minutes after topping. Bake covered: 12-15 minutes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Butter topping

- [ ] 12 Hawaiian sweet rolls
- [ ] 1 cup pizza or marinara sauce
- [ ] About 2 1/2 cups shredded mozzarella, divided
- [ ] 5 oz mini pepperoni
- [ ] 1/2 cup unsalted butter, melted [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp dried minced onion [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp grated Parmesan, plus more for garnish [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 tsp dried oregano [Bowl A]
- [ ] 3/4 tsp garlic powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp kosher salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp black pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp chopped parsley, optional

1. Fill rolls

1. Heat the oven to 375°F. Line and grease a 9×13-inch pan.

2. Slice 12 attached Hawaiian sweet rolls horizontally into top and bottom slabs. Put the bottom slab in the pan.

3. Spread with 1 cup pizza or marinara sauce. Add about 1/2 cup shredded mozzarella, 5 oz mini pepperoni, then the remaining about 2 cups mozzarella (about 2 1/2 cups total). Replace roll tops.

2. Add topping

1. Mix 1/2 cup melted unsalted butter, 2 Tbsp dried minced onion, 2 Tbsp grated Parmesan, 2 tsp dried oregano, 3/4 tsp garlic powder, 1/2 tsp kosher salt, and 1/4 tsp black pepper.

2. Spoon evenly over rolls and let stand 5-10 minutes.

3. Bake

1. Cover with foil and bake 12-15 minutes, until cheese melts.

2. Garnish with extra Parmesan and optional 1 Tbsp chopped parsley. Slice and serve warm.

Pressure Cooker Black Beans With Chorizo

Sides | Instant Pot

Before you start

Equipment: pressure cooker. High pressure: 40 minutes, plus time to reach pressure and release. Natural-release gives creamier beans; quick-release gives firmer beans.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Pressure-cooking aromatics

- [ ] 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- [ ] 6 oz Spanish-style chorizo, sliced into half-moons
- [ ] 1 lb dried black beans
- [ ] 1 onion, halved [Bowl A]
- [ ] 6 garlic cloves [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 orange, halved [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 bay leaves [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 quarts low-sodium chicken stock
- [ ] 2 tsp kosher salt, plus more to taste
- [ ] Chopped cilantro, for serving

1. Brown chorizo

1. Heat 1 Tbsp vegetable oil in the pressure cooker. Add 6 oz Spanish-style chorizo, sliced into half-moons.
2. Cook about 2 minutes, until it releases fat and begins to crisp.

2. Pressure-cook

1. Add 1 lb dried black beans, 1 halved onion, 6 garlic cloves, 1 halved orange, 2 bay leaves, 2 quarts low-sodium chicken stock, and 2 tsp kosher salt.
2. Cook at high pressure for 40 minutes.
3. Let pressure release naturally for especially tender, creamy beans, or quick-release for firmer beans.

3. Finish

1. Discard the onion, orange, and bay leaves. Adjust salt to taste and serve with chopped cilantro.

Notes

Firm cured sausages such as andouille or kielbasa can substitute for the chorizo.

Protein Pancakes

Breakfast | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Equipment: nonstick skillet and mixing bowl. Heat: medium-low to medium. Batter: thick but scoopable. Optional batter rest: 2-3 minutes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Protein powder and baking powder

- [ ] Cooking spray, butter, or coconut oil for the pan
- [ ] 2 large eggs
- [ ] 80 g protein powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp baking powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 cup sour cream or full-fat plain Greek yogurt
- [ ] Milk, almond milk, or water as needed to thin the batter

1. Mix batter

1. Heat a nonstick skillet over medium-low to medium heat. Grease lightly with cooking spray, butter, or coconut oil.

2. Whisk 2 large eggs until smooth. Whisk in 80 g protein powder and 1 tsp baking powder.

3. Stir in 1/2 cup sour cream or full-fat plain Greek yogurt until smooth.

4. If the batter is too stiff, add milk, almond milk, or water 1 Tbsp at a time until thick but scoopable. Let rest 2-3 minutes if convenient.

2. Cook

1. Scoop about 2-3 Tbsp batter per pancake into the skillet.

2. Flip when the edges are set and the underside is golden. Cook the second side just until done; avoid overcooking.

Notes

Protein powders absorb liquid differently, so adjust the batter rather than relying on one exact amount of liquid.

Avoid overcooking; it makes protein pancakes dry.

Protein Rice Crispy Treats

Treats | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Equipment: large pot and greased 9×13-inch pan. Set time: 1-2 hours. Measure the powder and cereal before melting the marshmallows; you will need to work quickly.

Ingredients

Keep these ingredients separate; follow the order in the directions.

- [ ] 3 Tbsp butter
- [ ] 6 cups marshmallows (about 11 oz)
- [ ] 1 cup protein powder (about 84 g)
- [ ] 6 cups Rice Krispies cereal (about 211 g)

1. Melt

1. Grease a 9×13-inch pan. Melt 3 Tbsp butter in a large pot over low heat.

2. Add 6 cups marshmallows (about 11 oz). Stir until completely smooth, then remove from the heat.

2. Mix and shape

1. Quickly stir in 1 cup protein powder (about 84 g), then fold in 6 cups Rice Krispies cereal (about 211 g) until evenly coated.

2. Press evenly into the greased pan, using greased hands or the back of a greased spoon if needed.

3. Let set

1. Let set 1-2 hours before cutting.

Shiitake Mushrooms

Sides | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Equipment: large pan. Cook: about 15 minutes, until mushrooms are golden brown.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Prepared mushrooms and onion

Bowl B - Final seasonings

- [ ] 3 lb shiitake mushrooms, sliced into bite-size pieces [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 large onion, diced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 3 Tbsp oil
- [ ] 1 Tbsp salt, or to taste [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 Tbsp ground black pepper, or to taste [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 cup chopped green onions

1. Prepare

1. Slice 3 lb shiitake mushrooms into bite-size pieces. Dice 1 large onion.

2. Sauté and finish

1. Heat 3 Tbsp oil in a large pan. Add the mushrooms and onion.

2. Sauté over medium-high heat, stirring occasionally, about 15 minutes, until mushrooms are golden brown.

3. Season with 1 Tbsp salt and 1/2 Tbsp ground black pepper, or to taste. Garnish with 1/2 cup chopped green onions and serve immediately.

Sicilian Pizza

Pasta & pizza | Oven

Before you start

Equipment: food processor, 13×18-inch rimmed baking sheet, and saucepan. Rise: 2-3 hours, plus 20-30 minutes if dough resists stretching. Oven: 550°F or as hot as allowed; preheat 30 minutes. Bake: about 10 minutes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Dough dry ingredients

Bowl B - Sauce aromatics

Bowl C - Tomatoes and sugar

Dough:

- [ ] 500 g bread flour [Bowl A]
- [ ] 14 g kosher salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 6 g instant yeast [Bowl A]
- [ ] 20 g extra-virgin olive oil, plus about 40 g for the pan
- [ ] 325 g room-temperature water

Sauce:

- [ ] 2 Tbsp extra-virgin olive oil
- [ ] 9 medium garlic cloves, roughly chopped [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp dried oregano [Bowl B]
- [ ] 2 tsp red pepper flakes [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 (28 oz) can whole peeled tomatoes [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1 tsp sugar [Bowl C]
- [ ] Kosher salt

Assembly:

- [ ] 1 lb sliced low-moisture mozzarella
- [ ] 12 oz natural-casing pepperoni, sliced about 1/8 inch thick
- [ ] 4 oz grated Pecorino Romano

1. Make dough

1. Process 500 g bread flour, 14 g kosher salt, 6 g instant yeast, 20 g extra-virgin olive oil, and 325 g room-temperature water until dough forms around the blade. Process about 30 seconds more.

2. Generously oil the baking sheet with about 40 g additional olive oil. Place dough in the pan and turn to coat.

2. Rise; make sauce while waiting

1. Cover dough and let rise 2-3 hours, until relaxed and puffy.

2. For the sauce, cook 9 roughly chopped medium garlic cloves, 1 Tbsp dried oregano, and 2 tsp red pepper flakes in 2 Tbsp olive oil about 1 minute.

3. Add one 28 oz can whole peeled tomatoes and crush them. Stir in 1 tsp sugar and simmer about 15 minutes. Season with kosher salt to taste.

3. Stretch and preheat

1. Gently stretch risen dough to the corners. If it springs back, rest 20-30 minutes and try again.

2. About 30 minutes before baking, put a rack in the lower oven and heat to 550°F, or as hot as your oven allows.

4. Top and bake

1. Cover dough with 1 lb overlapping low-moisture mozzarella slices. Spoon the prepared sauce over the cheese.

2. Add 12 oz natural-casing pepperoni, sliced about 1/8 inch thick, and 2 oz grated Pecorino Romano. Reserve another 2 oz Pecorino.

3. Bake about 10 minutes, until the bottom is golden and pepperoni is crisp. Tent with foil if the top darkens too quickly.

4. Finish with the reserved 2 oz Pecorino Romano.

Sous Vide Asparagus

Sides | Sous vide

Before you start

Equipment: sous-vide bath and vacuum bag. Bath: 180°F. Cook: 12 minutes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Dry seasonings

- [ ] 1 bunch asparagus
- [ ] 2 Tbsp butter, cut into 4 pieces
- [ ] 1/2 tsp salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp black pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp garlic powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 lemon, for squeezing over cooked asparagus

1. Bag asparagus

1. Preheat the bath to 180°F.

2. Put 1 bunch asparagus, 1/2 tsp salt, 1/4 tsp black pepper, and 1/2 tsp garlic powder in a vacuum bag. Shake to distribute.

3. Cut 2 Tbsp butter into 4 pieces and distribute evenly in the bag. Seal with asparagus in a single layer.

2. Cook and finish

1. Cook at 180°F for 12 minutes.

2. Open the bag and toss asparagus in the butter and seasonings. Squeeze 1/2 lemon over it, toss again, and serve.

Sous Vide Carrots

Sides | Sous vide

Before you start

Equipment: sous-vide bath, food-safe bag, and heavy skillet. Bath: 183°F. Cook: about 1 hour; glaze about 2 minutes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Butter, sugar, and initial salt

- [ ] 1 lb small carrots, or larger carrots peeled and cut into 1-inch pieces
- [ ] 2 Tbsp unsalted butter [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp sugar [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp kosher salt, plus more to taste [Bowl A]
- [ ] Water, 1 tsp at a time, only if glaze separates
- [ ] Black pepper
- [ ] 1 Tbsp chopped parsley, optional

1. Bag and cook

1. Preheat the bath to 183°F.

2. Seal 1 lb small carrots (or larger carrots peeled and cut into 1-inch pieces) with 2 Tbsp unsalted butter, 1 Tbsp sugar, and 1/2 tsp kosher salt.

3. Cook about 1 hour, until fully tender.

2. Glaze

1. Empty the entire bag, including liquid, into a heavy skillet. Cook over high heat, stirring constantly, about 2 minutes, until the liquid becomes a shiny glaze.

2. If the glaze separates, add water 1 tsp at a time while shaking the pan.

3. Season with salt and black pepper to taste. Stir in optional 1 Tbsp chopped parsley and serve.

Sous Vide Chicken Breast

Chicken | Sous vide

Before you start

Equipment: sous-vide bath, food-safe bag, and heavy skillet. Choose a temperature and matching cooking time from the source guide below. Skillet finish: about 2 minutes skin-side down.

Ingredients

Keep these ingredients separate; follow the order in the directions.

- [ ] 2 bone-in, skin-on chicken breast halves
- [ ] Kosher salt and black pepper
- [ ] 4 sprigs thyme or rosemary, optional
- [ ] Oil for finishing in a skillet

Source temperature guide

140°F: very soft and juicy, 1 1/2-4 hours

150°F: tender and juicy, 1-4 hours

160°F: traditional, firm and juicy, 1-4 hours

1. Season and cook

1. Preheat the bath to your chosen setting from the source temperature guide.

2. Season 2 bone-in, skin-on chicken breast halves generously with kosher salt and black pepper. Bag with optional 4 thyme or rosemary sprigs.

3. Use the matching temperature and time: 140°F for 1 1/2-4 hours; 150°F for 1-4 hours; or 160°F for 1-4 hours.

2. Dry and sear

1. Remove chicken from the bag, discard herbs, and pat very dry.

2. For crisp skin, heat oil in a heavy skillet over medium-high heat. Sear skin-side down about 2 minutes, pressing the chicken flat for even contact.

3. Rest briefly. Remove bones if desired, slice, and serve.

Notes

Personal note from Recipe Index: 153°F for 1 hour.

The source gives a 1-4 hour range at 150°F and 160°F; 153°F is between those listed settings.

Sous Vide Ribs

Beef & pork | Sous vide

Before you start

Equipment: grinder, sous-vide bath, food-safe bags, ice bath, saucepan, and oven. Plan ahead: refrigerate seasoned ribs 4-12 hours; cook 36 hours at 145°F or 12 hours at 165°F. Oven finish: about 40 minutes at 300°F.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Dry rub; reserve 3 Tbsp

Bowl B - Sauce base

Dry rub:

- [ ] 1/3 cup paprika [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/3 cup dark brown sugar [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 cup kosher salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp whole yellow mustard seed [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp black pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp garlic powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp dried oregano [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp whole coriander seed [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp red pepper flakes [Bowl A]

Sauce and ribs:

- [ ] 1 medium yellow onion, grated [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 1/2 cups ketchup [Bowl B]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp spicy brown mustard [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/3 cup dark molasses [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4 cup Worcestershire sauce [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4 cup apple cider vinegar [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 1/2 tsp liquid hickory smoke
- [ ] 2 racks St. Louis-cut pork ribs

1. Prepare rub and ribs

1. Remove the membrane from 2 racks St. Louis-cut pork ribs. Cut each rack into portions containing 3-4 ribs.

2. Grind together 1/3 cup paprika, 1/3 cup dark brown sugar, 1/4 cup kosher salt, 2 Tbsp whole yellow mustard seed, 1 tsp black pepper, 2 Tbsp garlic powder, 1 Tbsp dried oregano, 1 Tbsp whole coriander seed, and 1 tsp red pepper flakes.

3. Reserve 3 Tbsp dry rub for the sauce (or for a dry-style finish). Season ribs generously with the rest.

4. Bag rib portions with about 4 drops liquid hickory smoke per bag, taken from the total 1 1/2 tsp. Seal and refrigerate 4-12 hours.

2. Sous vide and chill

1. For a meatier texture, cook at 145°F for 36 hours. For a more traditional barbecue texture, cook at 165°F for 12 hours.

2. Chill the cooked ribs in ice water.

3. Make sauce

1. Simmer the reserved 3 Tbsp rub with 1 grated medium yellow onion, 1 1/2 cups ketchup, 2 Tbsp spicy brown mustard, 1/3 cup dark molasses, 1/4 cup Worcestershire sauce, 1/4 cup apple cider vinegar, and the liquid smoke remaining from the original 1 1/2 tsp. Simmer about 20 minutes.

4. Finish in the oven

1. Heat the oven to 300°F. Pat the ribs dry and heat in the oven about 20 minutes.

2. Brush with some prepared sauce and bake 10 minutes. Brush again and bake another 10 minutes, until sticky.

3. Add a final coat of sauce to serve.

Notes

Dry-style option: omit the sauce-making stage. Coat the cooked ribs with the reserved 3 Tbsp dry rub before finishing.

For dry-style ribs, skip the sauce and coat the cooked ribs with the reserved dry rub before finishing.

Sous Vide Steak

Beef & pork | Sous vide

Before you start

Equipment: sous-vide bath, food-safe bag, and searing pan. Best suited to steaks 1 1/2-2 inches thick. Choose a matching temperature/time from the guide below; your personal setting is retained in the notes.

Ingredients

Keep these ingredients separate; follow the order in the directions.

- [ ] Steak, ideally 1 1/2-2 inches thick
- [ ] Kosher salt and black pepper
- [ ] Thyme or rosemary, optional
- [ ] High-heat oil for searing

Temperature guide for strip/ribeye/porterhouse and similar cuts

Rare: 120-128°F, 1-2 1/2 hours

Medium-rare: 129-134°F, 1-4 hours

Medium: 135-144°F, 1-4 hours

Medium-well: 145-155°F, 1-3 1/2 hours

1. Season and cook

1. Preheat the bath to your chosen temperature from the temperature guide.

2. Season steak, ideally 1 1/2-2 inches thick, generously with kosher salt and black pepper. Add optional thyme or rosemary and seal in a bag.

3. Cook using the matching range: rare 120-128°F for 1-2 1/2 hours; medium-rare 129-134°F for 1-4 hours; medium 135-144°F for 1-4 hours; or medium-well 145-155°F for 1-3 1/2 hours.

4. For any setting below 130°F, do not hold longer than 2 1/2 hours, as specified in the saved source note.

2. Dry and sear

1. Remove from the bag and pat very dry.

2. Heat a small amount of high-heat oil in a very hot pan. Sear briefly until both sides and edges are well browned.

Notes

Personal note from Recipe Index: 144°F.

The source classifies 144°F as the upper end of medium for strip/ribeye/porterhouse-type cuts.

Steaks below 130°F should not be held longer than 2 1/2 hours according to the source.

Sous Vide Tuna

Seafood | Sous vide

Before you start

Equipment: sous-vide bath, food-safe bag, and heavy skillet. Plan ahead: refrigerate seasoned tuna 30 minutes to overnight. For the listed 1 1/2-2-inch steaks, the saved cooking chart gives 45-60 minutes; choose temperature using the guide below.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Bag oil and optional aromatics

- [ ] 2 tuna steaks, 10-12 oz each and about 1 1/2-2 inches thick
- [ ] Kosher salt and black pepper
- [ ] 2 Tbsp extra-virgin olive oil [Bowl A]
- [ ] Thyme, dill, parsley, shallot, or citrus zest, optional [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 cup sesame seeds, optional for searing
- [ ] 2 Tbsp vegetable oil for searing

Temperature guide

105°F: nearly raw, slightly firmed; good chilled

110°F: very moist and just firmed; good for searing

115°F: meaty and moist; good for searing

120°F: firm and relatively dry

130°F: canned-tuna-like texture

1. Season and bag

1. Season 2 tuna steaks, 10-12 oz each and about 1 1/2-2 inches thick, generously with kosher salt and black pepper.

2. Bag in a single layer with 2 Tbsp extra-virgin olive oil and optional thyme, dill, parsley, shallot, or citrus zest. Refrigerate at least 30 minutes and up to overnight.

2. Cook

1. Preheat the bath to your chosen temperature from the temperature guide. Use water displacement rather than a strong vacuum if possible, to avoid deforming the tuna.

2. Cook 45-60 minutes for 1-2-inch-thick steaks. If using steaks 1 inch thick or less, cook 30-45 minutes instead.

3. Sear

1. Remove tuna and blot very dry. For a seared finish, season with black pepper or coat with optional 1/2 cup sesame seeds.

2. Heat 2 Tbsp vegetable oil in a heavy skillet until lightly smoking. Sear 30-45 seconds per side, then briefly sear the edges.

Notes

Timing clarification: your personal note says 110°F for 40 minutes. The saved source chart gives 45-60 minutes for the listed thicker steaks; the 40-minute note is preserved below as your preference.

Personal note from Recipe Index: cook at 110°F for 40 minutes, sear; maybe 105°F for rarer tuna.

The source specifically recommends 110°F for very moist seared tuna and 105°F for a nearly raw, sashimi-like texture.

Teriyaki Salmon

Seafood | Oven

Before you start

Equipment: baking sheet and saucepan. Oven: 400°F. Marinate: about 20 minutes. Bake: 12-16 minutes; reduce reserved sauce while salmon bakes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Teriyaki mixture; reserve finishing portion

- [ ] 2 1/2 lb salmon, cut into roughly 2-inch-wide portions

Sauce:

- [ ] 3 Tbsp teriyaki sauce [Bowl A]
- [ ] 3 Tbsp hoisin sauce [Bowl A]
- [ ] 3 Tbsp soy sauce [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp white vinegar [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp sesame oil [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/3 cup packed light brown sugar [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2-3 garlic cloves, minced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 tsp fresh grated ginger, or 1/2 tsp ground ginger [Bowl A]
- [ ] Sesame seeds and sliced green onion, for garnish

1. Mix sauce and marinate

1. Heat the oven to 400°F and lightly grease a baking sheet.

2. Whisk 3 Tbsp teriyaki sauce, 3 Tbsp hoisin sauce, 3 Tbsp soy sauce, 1 Tbsp white vinegar, 1 Tbsp sesame oil, 1/3 cup packed light brown sugar, 2-3 minced garlic cloves, and 2 tsp freshly grated ginger (or 1/2 tsp ground ginger).

3. Cut 2 1/2 lb salmon into roughly 2-inch-wide portions. Marinate in some sauce about 20 minutes. Keep the rest separate for finishing.

2. Bake and reduce sauce

1. Arrange salmon on the baking sheet. Bake 12-16 minutes, depending on thickness.

2. Meanwhile, bring the reserved sauce to a boil, then simmer 3-4 minutes, until slightly syrupy.

3. Finish

1. Brush cooked salmon with the reduced sauce. Garnish with sesame seeds and sliced green onion.

The Best Lemon Loaf

Treats | Oven

Before you start

Equipment: 9×5-inch loaf pan and mixing bowls. Oven: 350°F. Bake: about 50-52 minutes. Cool in pan at least 30 minutes, then completely before glazing.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - First wet mixture

Bowl B - Dry ingredients

Bowl C - Glaze

Bowl D - Lemon flavorings

Lemon loaf:

- [ ] 3 large eggs [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 cup granulated sugar [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 cup sour cream or Greek yogurt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 cup canola or vegetable oil
- [ ] 2 Tbsp lemon zest [Bowl D]
- [ ] 1-2 Tbsp lemon extract, to taste [Bowl D]
- [ ] 1 1/2 cups all-purpose flour [Bowl B]
- [ ] 2 tsp baking powder [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp salt [Bowl B]

Glaze:

- [ ] 1 cup confectioners' sugar [Bowl C]
- [ ] About 3 Tbsp lemon juice, adjusted for consistency [Bowl C]

1. Prepare and mix wet ingredients

1. Heat the oven to 350°F. Grease and flour a 9×5-inch loaf pan.
2. Whisk 3 large eggs, 1 cup granulated sugar, and 1 cup sour cream or Greek yogurt until smooth.
3. Slowly whisk in 1/2 cup canola or vegetable oil. Add 2 Tbsp lemon zest and 1-2 Tbsp lemon extract, to taste.

2. Add dry ingredients and bake

1. Stir in 1 1/2 cups all-purpose flour, 2 tsp baking powder, and 1/2 tsp salt just until combined. Do not overmix.
2. Pour into the pan and bake about 50-52 minutes. Tent loosely with foil near the end if the top browns too quickly.

Original recipe | Google Doc

3. Cool and glaze

1. Cool in the pan at least 30 minutes, then cool completely before glazing.

2. Whisk 1 cup confectioners' sugar with about 3 Tbsp lemon juice, adjusting juice for a smooth glaze. Drizzle over the cooled loaf.

Tini's Mac and Cheese

Pasta & pizza | Oven

Before you start

Equipment: 9×13-inch baking dish and skillet. Oven: 350°F, then broil. Bake: 25-30 minutes; broil about 2 minutes. Cheese and seasoning are each divided before cooking.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Cheese mixture; divide after mixing

Bowl B - Seasoning mixture; divide in half

- [ ] 1 lb cavatappi, cooked
- [ ] 16 oz mozzarella, grated [Bowl A]
- [ ] 16 oz Colby Jack, grated [Bowl A]
- [ ] 8 oz Cheddar, grated [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp garlic powder [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 tsp smoked paprika [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp salt [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp pepper [Bowl B]
- [ ] 3 Tbsp butter
- [ ] 3 Tbsp flour
- [ ] 1 (12 oz) can evaporated milk
- [ ] 2 cups heavy cream
- [ ] 1 Tbsp Dijon mustard

1. Prepare pasta and divided ingredients

1. Heat the oven to 350°F and grease a 9×13-inch baking dish. Cook and drain 1 lb cavatappi.

2. Mix 16 oz grated mozzarella, 16 oz grated Colby Jack, and 8 oz grated Cheddar. Divide into two equal 20 oz portions: one for the sauce, one for layering.

3. Mix 1 tsp garlic powder, 1 tsp smoked paprika, 1/2 tsp salt, and 1/2 tsp pepper. Divide this seasoning mixture in half.

2. Make the cheese sauce

1. Melt 3 Tbsp butter in a skillet. Stir in 3 Tbsp flour and half the seasoning mixture (equivalent to 1/2 tsp garlic powder, 1/2 tsp paprika, 1/4 tsp salt, and 1/4 tsp pepper). Cook 3-5 minutes, until paste-like.

2. Whisk in one 12 oz can evaporated milk until thickened.

3. Add 2 cups heavy cream, the remaining half of the seasoning mixture, and 1 Tbsp Dijon mustard.

4. Gradually melt in the 20 oz cheese portion reserved for the sauce. Stir in the cooked cavatappi.

3. Layer and bake

1. Spread half the macaroni mixture in the baking dish. Add half the reserved layering cheese (10 oz). Repeat with the remaining macaroni and remaining 10 oz cheese.

2. Bake 25-30 minutes, until bubbly. Broil about 2 minutes to brown the top.

Tzatziki Sauce

Appetizers | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Equipment: grater, fine-mesh strainer, and bowl. Drain cucumber: 5 minutes. Optional flavor-development time: at least 30 minutes chilled.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Cucumber for draining

Bowl B - Yogurt dressing

- [ ] 2 cups plain Greek yogurt [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 English cucumber, shredded; drain and squeeze as directed [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp salt for draining cucumber [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 medium garlic clove, finely minced or grated [Bowl B]
- [ ] Juice of 1/2 lemon [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 tsp fresh dill, or 1/2 tsp dried dill [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 tsp salt, or to taste [Bowl B]

1. Drain cucumber

1. Shred 1 English cucumber into a fine-mesh strainer. Sprinkle with 1 tsp salt and let stand 5 minutes.
2. Squeeze thoroughly to remove excess water.

2. Mix and chill

1. Combine the drained cucumber with 2 cups plain Greek yogurt, 1 finely minced or grated medium garlic clove, juice of 1/2 lemon, 1 tsp fresh dill (or 1/2 tsp dried dill), and 1 tsp salt, or to taste.
2. Serve immediately or chill at least 30 minutes for the flavors to develop. Adjust salt, garlic, or dill to taste.